

LOCATIONS

CONTINENTAL OVERVIEW

[Quick Reference Map - Solis's Era]

COUNTRIES & CAPITALS

Aicruae - Capital: Lajazer (Westernmost)

Pireaynea - Capital: Civer (South-central)

Gherci - Capital: Tarmet (Central)

Coelum — Capital: Atriki (North-central)

Equateiy - Capital: Ociyaran (Northeastern highlands)

Vikitsv - Capital: Berlailia (Eastern peninsula)

RELATIVE POSITIONS (From Gherci)

•

North: Coelum

Southwest: Pireaynea

West: Aicruae

East: Vikitsv

Northeast: Equateiy

MAJOR SEAS

The Quather Sea - Northwest, borders Aicruae

The Fetora Sea - Southern coastline (shared by Vikitsv, Pireaynea, Aicruae)

The Obery Sea - Northeastern coastline (borders Equateiy, Vikitsv)

Henem Bay - North of Coelum

OTHER NOTABLE FEATURES

-

The Mystic Isles - Southwest of Aicruae, isolated archipelago

Mountain Ranges - Northwest of Coelum (northern border); sharp ridges separating Equateiy from Coelum and Vikitsv

Major Rivers - One flowing south through Gherci from near Coelum; tributaries crisscrossing Vikitsv

CONTINENTAL OVERVIEW

[Quick Reference Map - Crandona's Era]

NATIONS & CAPITALS (Current vs Former Names)

Tanan Grand Duchy - Capital: [TBD] (Formerly: Aicruae) - Westernmost

Caporiolan Kingdom — Capital: [TBD] (Formerly: Gherci) — Central, Imperial Seat

Lingia - Capital: [TBD] (Formerly: Pireaynea) - Southwest

Hikai - Capital: [TBD] (Formerly: Coelum) - Northeast

Uxridian Grand Duchy - Capital: [TBD] (Formerly: Equateiy) - Easternmost

Theolisseia - Capital: [TBD] (Formerly: Vikitsv) - Southeast

Thult - (Formerly: The Mystic Isles) - South, "The Land of Sand"

RELATIVE POSITIONS (Empire-Centric)

West: Tanan Grand Duchy (agrarian, now a duchy)

Southwest: Lingia (dry, bordering wastelands)

Center: Caporiolan Kingdom (Imperial Capital, administrative seat)

Northeast: Hikai (scholarly or mystical, elevated zone)

East: Uxridian Grand Duchy (powerful duchy with sea access)

Southeast: Theolisseia (wilderness, borderland forests)

South: Thult (dead zone, magical collapse)

MAJOR SEAS

–

The Quather Sea - West, borders Tanan Grand Duchy

Orburydon Sea (Formerly the Obery Sea)— Northeast/East, borders Hikai and Uxridian Grand Duchy

Thult (Southern Waters) — South of Lingia (formerly The Fetora Sea)

LANDSCAPE CHANGES FROM SOLIS'S ERA

Tanan Grand Duchy: Predominantly green and temperate; fertile with gentle elevation. Agrarian and stable.

Caporiolan Kingdom: Transitional terrain-rolling plains, central rivers, moderate elevation. Strategic heartland suitable for administration and overland trade. No direct coastline.

Lingia: More arid than in Solis's Era; hot, semi-dry zone transitioning toward desert near Thult.

Hikai: Alpine and elevated terrain; lighter green forests and plateaus. Likely spiritual or arcane in culture.

Uxridian Grand Duchy: Balanced region with sea, river systems, and forests. Powerful economic and naval region.

Theolisseia: Dense forested and humid subtropical zone. Rivers throughout-ideal for resource extraction. Wild and culturally distinct.

Thult (Mystic Isles): Now barren or desertified. Historically magical, but war-torn, corrupted, or drained of power. The Academy may be the last remnant of past grandeur.

CONTINENTAL OVERVIEW

[Quick Reference Map - Minara's Era]

PROVINCES & CAPITALS

Lajazer - Capital: Vellin (Formerly: Aicruae → Tanan Grand Duchy) - Western coast

Tarmet - Capital: Bela (Formerly: Gherci → Caporiolan Kingdom) - North-central, Overall Capital of the Entire Empire

Civer - Capital: Lorne (Formerly: Pireaynea → Lingia) - South-central

Atriki - Capital: Elgan (Formerly: Coelum → Hikai) - Southeast-central

Ociyaran - Capital: Zada (Formerly: Equateiy → Uxridian Grand Duchy) - Northeast

Berlailia - Capital: Zemela (Formerly: Vikitsv → Theolisseia) - Southeastern peninsula

Thult - No political boundary drawn (Formerly: The Mystic Isles) - South of Berlailia, isolated RELATIVE POSITIONS

West to East: Lajazer → Tarmet → Ociyaran

Southwest to Southeast: Civer → Atriki → Berlailia

Thult: South of Berlailia, isolated by water

MAJOR SEAS

-

The Quather Sea - Northwest, borders Lajazer

The Henem Bay - North-central coast, borders Tarmet

The Oberya Sea - East, borders Ociyaran and Berlailia

The Fetora Sea - South, borders Civer, Atriki, and Berlailia

GEOGRAPHIC FEATURES

Rivers: Multiple long rivers feed from central highlands (Tarmet, Atriki) in all directions. Rivers are central to city placement; nearly all cities sit on river networks.

Roads and Trade: Dense road systems connect all major cities. Coastal and inland cities are heavily interconnected, implying a strong, possibly unified empire.

The Academy: Located near the southern edge, west of Civer. Scholarly or magical institution with neutral status.

LANDSCAPE BY PROVINCE

Lajazer: Coastal and hilly with natural barriers. Maritime and defensive power. Forested interior with abundant resources.

Tarmet: River-fed interior with possible floodplains. Centralized governance; ideal for capital or trade crossroads.

Civer: Plains and grasslands, crisscrossed by trade roads and rivers. Historically fertile and populated.

Atriki: Slightly elevated interior with central hills or plateaus. No direct coastal access. Possibly mystical, religious, or ancient stronghold.

Ociyaran: Rugged and elevated (possibly mountainous) interior with coastal cliffs. Culturally isolated, potentially militarized or arcane.

Berlailia: Fertile, humid river delta zone. Potential for naval power, trade, or tropical diversity. Coastline on both Oberyia Sea (east) and Fetora Sea (south).

Thult: Arid, likely desertified or magically ruined. Possibly still home to ruins or forbidden zones.

CONTINENTAL OVERVIEW

[Quick Reference Map - Minara's Era]

PROVINCES & CAPITALS

-

Lajazer — Capital: Vellin (Formerly: Aicruae → Tanan Grand Duchy) — Western coast

Tarmet - Capital: Bela (Formerly: Gherci → Caporiolan Kingdom) - North-central, Overall Capital of the Entire Empire

Civer - Capital: Lorne (Formerly: Pireaynea → Lingia) - South-central

Atriki - Capital: Elgan (Formerly: Coelum → Hikai) - Southeast-central

Ociyaran - Capital: Zada (Formerly: Equateiy → Uxridian Grand Duchy) - Northeast

Berlailia - Capital: Zemela (Formerly: Vikitsv → Theolisseia) - Southeastern peninsula

Thult - No political boundary drawn (Formerly: The Mystic Isles) - South of Berlailia, isolated

RELATIVE POSITIONS

-

West to East: Lajazer → Tarmet → Ociyaran

Southwest to Southeast: Civer → Atriki → Berlailia

Thult: South of Berlailia, isolated by water

MAJOR SEAS

—

The Quather Sea - Northwest, borders Lajazer

The Henem Bay - North-central coast, borders Tarmet

The Obery Sea (Named Changed back to Obery during this time)- East, borders Ociyaran and Berlailia

The Fetora Sea - South, borders Civer, Atriki, and Berlailia

GEOGRAPHIC FEATURES

Rivers: Multiple long rivers feed from central highlands (Tarmet, Atriki) in all directions. Rivers are central to city placement; nearly all cities sit on river networks.

Roads and Trade: Dense road systems connect all major cities. Coastal and inland cities are heavily interconnected, implying a strong, possibly unified empire.

The Academy: Located near the southern edge, west of Civer. Scholarly or magical institution with neutral status.

LANDSCAPE BY PROVINCE

Lajazer: Coastal and hilly with natural barriers. Maritime and defensive power. Forested interior with abundant resources.

Tarmet: River-fed interior with possible floodplains. Centralized governance; ideal for capital or trade crossroads.

Civer: Plains and grasslands, crisscrossed by trade roads and rivers. Historically fertile and populated.

Atriki: Slightly elevated interior with central hills or plateaus. No direct coastal access. Possibly mystical, religious, or ancient stronghold.

Ociyaran: Rugged and elevated (possibly mountainous) interior with coastal cliffs. Culturally isolated, potentially militarized or arcane.

Berlailia: Fertile, humid river delta zone. Potential for naval power, trade, or tropical diversity. Coastline on both Obery Sea (east) and Fetora Sea (south).

Thult: Arid, likely desertified or magically ruined. Possibly still home to ruins or forbidden zones.

THE ACADEMY ISLAND [Type: Magical Institution / Neutral Territory]

BASIC INFORMATION

—Name: The Academy Island Also Known As: The Academy Type: Magical institution and surrounding settlement on an island Nation: Neutral (located between Civer and Atriki borders on the main continent, in the Fetora Sea) Region: Southern edge of the continent, offshore Population: [TBD]

GEOGRAPHY & LAYOUT

- Physical Setting: A two-lobed peninsula jutting south from a barrier line, sitting a few miles offshore in the Fetora Sea, directly south of the Civer-Atriki border on the main continent.

Climate: [TBD]

Layout/Structure: The entire island is deliberately compartmentalized into three zones connected by a narrow isthmus:

Upper Peninsula (Academy Plateau): Surrounded by the Main Barrier—a solid, curved wall enclosing the core institution. Contains: Academy Building (central),

Library (NW edge), Training Grounds (north), Male Dorms (NE), Female Dorms (east). Raised plateau transitioning to gentle slopes toward the sea.

Isthmus / Between the Barriers: A narrow land bridge connecting the Academy plateau to the lower peninsula. Marked by a corridor path running between the Main Barrier and the Second Barrier.

Lower Peninsula (Outer Town): Enclosed by the Second Barrier (a lighter, outer wall). Contains shops and administrative buildings. Cafe Iri sits at the southern tip, a small outlying settlement just beyond the Second Barrier.

Notable Districts/Areas: Academy Plateau, Outer Town, Cafe Iri

Landmarks: The Main Barrier, The Second Barrier, The Library, Training Grounds, World Portals (located on a separate landmass to the west of the island)

GOVERNANCE

- Who Rules Here: [TBD] Local Government: [TBD] Relationship to Crown: Appears to hold neutral status independent of surrounding provinces

ECONOMY & FUNCTION

—Primary Purpose: Magical education and training Industries: Scholarly and magical instruction What It's Famous For: Being the primary magical academy; possibly the last remnant of the Mystic Isles' past grandeur Trade Significance: [TBD]

CULTURE & CHARACTER

—Atmosphere: [TBD] Local Customs: [TBD] Religious Sites: [TBD] Festivals Held Here: [TBD]

DEMOGRAPHICS

—Who Lives Here: Students, faculty, support staff, Outer Town merchants and residents Social

Classes Present: [TBD] Notable Residents: [TBD]

HISTORY

—Founded: [TBD] Major Historical Events: [TBD] Changes Over Time: Appears across all three map eras (Crandona's and Minara's), suggesting it has endured through major political upheavals

SENSORY DETAILS

- What It Looks Like: [TBD] What It Sounds Like: [TBD] What It Smells Like: [TBD] Unique Visual Details: No natural rivers on the island-water likely supplied via magic or cisterns. Dotted paths suggest internal roads or magical pathways connecting each zone.

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

- Scenes Set Here: [TBD] Why Characters Come Here: Magical education, training Significance to Plot: [TBD]

NOTES

- The World Portals are located on a separate landmass to the west of the Academy Island, connected by what appears to be a dashed pathway (possibly a bridge, ferry route, or magical connection).

The island's compartmentalized design (inner sanctum → staff/student town → recreational café) suggests strict access control, with the barriers serving as both physical and possibly magical boundaries.

Across eras: Appears as "The Academy" in both the Crandona's Era map (south of Lingia) and the Minara's Era map (southwest of Civer). Its persistence through regime changes suggests institutional independence or neutrality that transcends political borders. Please note that before Emperor Goteivati Zivc Patton III reign The Academy was primarily just a school for adolescent nobility, before magic was introduced formally into the empire and it transitioned into being a magical education infrastructure.

→THE CIDET [Type: Temple Complex]

BASIC INFORMATION

Name: The Cidet Also Known As: The temple of the Gods

Type: Temple complex

Dates:

Nation:

Region:

Population: 9 million pilgrims yearly

Governance: The Cidet is governed by the Danepelie, a council of senior priests representing all twelve gods. No single nation controls the Cidet - it maintains sacred neutrality. The Danepelie operates with:

Own temple guards - volunteers who sever all national allegiances upon joining

Own treasury - funded entirely by pilgrim donations

Own laws - religious law supersedes secular law within temple grounds

The High Conclave guards the Cidet's independence.

Aicruan Influence: Despite the Cidet's neutrality, Aicruae exerts the most influence due to geographic proximity. Aicruan guards patrol the pilgrim road, Aicruan merchants dominate the surrounding commerce, and Aicruae provides the largest donations. Because Aicruae sits so close to the Cidet, the country has unofficial rights to it despite the Cidet being its own functioning entity.

Historical Note: When Solis attacked the Cidet during Chapter 29 of A Tale of a Thousand Songs, he violated sacred ground — an act that turned the church against him. Post-war, repairing his relationship with the Cidet became one of Solis's most important political projects.

(See also: KEY WORDS AND TERMS - Danepelie entry)

Physical Setting: Accessible via well-maintained road from Lajazer

Climate:

Layout/Structure:

- The Hall of Twelve: Central sanctuary with altars to all twelve gods arranged in a circle
- The Room of Glory: Rebuilt by Phiyano Mena, containing religious relics and architectural marvels
- The Hero's Hall: Also built with Mena involvement; honors great figures
- Individual shrines: Smaller temples dedicated to specific gods for focused prayer
- Priests' quarters and training facilities
- Pilgrim hostels: Simple lodging for visitors

Notable Districts/Areas:

- Sacred pools for ritual bathing
- Designated areas for sacrifices (Leneyez practices)
- Private chambers for royal visits

Landmarks:

- The Hall of Twelve
- The Room of Glory
- The Hero's Hall

GOVERNANCE

Who Rules Here: Religious Institution

Local Government:

Relationship to Crown: The Cidet itself maintains official neutrality, offering facilities for all practices

ECONOMY & FUNCTION

Primary Purpose: Religious pilgrimage site for the Circle of Eternal Light

Industries:

What It's Famous For: Holding "the temple of the Gods"

Trade Significance: Blessed items sold to pilgrims.

CULTURE & CHARACTER

Atmosphere:

Local Customs: Pilgrims wear white; all classes look similar during pilgrimage Last day of journey is walked barefoot as a sign of humility (wealthy pilgrims who've ridden in carriages must walk at least this portion)

Religious Sites: The entire complex is a religious site dedicated to the twelve gods of the Circle of Eternal Light

Festivals Held Here:

- Solstice celebrations: The Cidet's grandest events

- Royal pilgrimages: When royalty visits, common pilgrims clear the way; the monarch performs special rites in private chambers
- Funeral rites for great figures: Though bodies are buried in home territories, memorial services at the Cidet honor major deaths
- Major festivals bring everyone together; sacrifices (for Leneyez) happen in designated areas

DEMOGRAPHICS

Who Lives Here: Priests, temple servants, pilgrims who never leave and join the priesthood

Social Classes Present: All classes; pilgrims travel from all backgrounds

Notable Residents:

HISTORY

Founded:

Major Historical Events:

- The Room of Glory rebuilt by Phiyano Mena
- The Hero's Hall built with Mena involvement
- The Massacre of Light nearly wiped out the Order of the Pure Ones (heretical sect)

Changes Over Time:

SENSORY DETAILS

What It Looks Like: Pilgrims approaching wear white, making all classes look similar

What It Sounds Like:

What It Smells Like:

Unique Visual Details:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Scenes Set Here:

Why Characters Come Here: Pilgrimage, seeking blessings, prayer, consultation with priests, healing, confession, attendance at ceremonies

Significance to Plot:

NOTES

EXPERIENCE:

Approaching the Cidet: Pilgrims travel the well-maintained road from Lajazer, often in groups for safety Last day of journey is walked barefoot as a sign of humility (wealthy pilgrims who've ridden in carriages must walk at least this portion) Pilgrims wear white; all classes look similar during pilgrimage

Arrival and Purification: Ritual bathing in sacred pools before entering temple grounds Leaving an offering at the entrance: coins for the wealthy, food or handmade items for the poor Receiving a blessing from a minor priest (water sprinkled, prayer spoken)

Typical Pilgrim Rituals: Circle the Hall of Twelve, offering a prayer or small gift at each altar Specific prayers at the shrine of whichever god is most relevant to their need (Zopha for sailors, Allan for farmers, etc.) Consultation with a priest; seeking advice, confession, or requesting special prayers Attendance at a communal ceremony (held multiple times daily) Purchasing blessed items: small Solari brooches, vials of holy water, prayer beads

Duration of Stay: Minimum: One full day and night (arriving afternoon, departing next afternoon) Common: Three days (one day arriving/purifying, one day of worship, one day departing) Extended: A week or more for serious penitents or those seeking healing Permanent: Some pilgrims never leave, becoming temple servants or joining the priesthood

THE CIDET

-

Region: Near Aicruae (Aicruae has unofficial rights to it)

Type: Temple / Religious Center

Annual Visitors: ~ 9 Million

Description: The Cidet holds the Temple of the Gods. People from all over the world travel to the Cidet to worship.

Although it sits close to Aicruae, the Cidet functions as its own entity - no country formally claims sovereignty over it.

War Significance — Solis's Attack (7,219 BR):

During Civil War Year Three, Solis attacked the Cidet because Mihel had fallen into a coma after Harnua's betrayal at Nyeo. This attack on sacred ground was deeply controversial — it turned the church officially against Solis. Orcus rescued Harnua from the temple and offered to house her in his castle.

Chapter Reference: Ch. 29 (Year Three)

Cross-references:

- HARNUA KULIO (In Story Characters)
- SOLIS ELIAS PATTON (In Story Characters)
- CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT (Religion)

THREE SUB-RELIGIONS WITHIN THE CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT:

Leneyez (House Patton, Vika, Vemer, Kulio, Najil, Hige): Believes in sacrificing people and animals to maintain gods' physical and spiritual well-being

Rillic (House Vika, Caraen, Mena): Believes humans fuel gods' strength and give them a tether to the mortal world

Barqeten (House Arvento, Leva, Aedria, Yurea): Believes simply existing is worship; emphasizes physical and mental wellness

Note: House Vika follows both Leneyez AND Rillic; this tracks with their militant, sacrifice-oriented nature.

Tensions and Interactions:

Leneyez vs. Barqeten (the biggest divide): Leneyez followers see Barqeten as lazy and disrespectful: "You think just existing honors the gods? Where is your sacrifice?" Barqeten followers see Leneyez as barbaric: "The gods gave us life;

they don't want us to waste it in blood" These groups tend to worship at different times at shared temples to avoid conflict Mixed marriages are possible but cause family drama; typically the woman adopts her husband's family's practice (or vice versa for uxori-local marriages)

Rillic as the middle ground: Rillic adherents believe in serving the gods through existence and action, but without blood sacrifice They can often mediate between Leneyez and Barqeten House Caraen (Rillic followers who protect the capital) work alongside House Patton (Leneyez) without major conflict because Rillic accepts that some give their lives in service

Practical Coexistence: All three groups worship the same twelve gods; the disagreement is about how, not whom Major festivals bring everyone together; sacrifices (for Leneyez) happen in designated areas The Cidet itself likely maintains official neutrality, offering facilities for all practices

Intermarriage: Common, but children typically follow the father's family's tradition. Converts exist but are viewed with mild suspicion ("Why would you choose to sacrifice animals if you weren't raised to it?")

THE ORDER OF THE PURE ONES (DIFFERENT CATEGORY):

This is an actual heretical sect that worships human saints instead of gods The Massacre of Light nearly wiped them out Survivors practice in secret House Dajanyi is noted as one of the few families still following this order openly Followers of all three mainstream sub-religions would view Pure Ones with suspicion or hostility

BASIC INFORMATION

Official Name: Aicruae

Dates:

Common Names: The Land Under the Sun

Flag:

- Flag Colors: Gold: The Gold Color of The Flag of Aicruae is meant to represent Razar; deep gold is reserved for royalty but it appears in the flag as a symbol

of Razar and the light that will never fail to shine upon the land of Aicruae.

Blue: The Blue Color of The Flag of Aicruae is meant to represent, The Sky and The Sea, The magnificent blue that represents the joy of Aicruaeans (The Aicruaeans are the people of Aicruae).

Black: The Black Color of The Flag of Aicruae is meant to represent Mourning, for all the souls of Aicruaeans that have been lost and the grief for all the bloodshed needed to create Aicruae.

White: The White Color of The Flag of Aicruae is meant to represent unity of all Aicruaeans even the king and the crown in the worship of the gods of old and the gods of new under The Circle of Eternal Light. The flag is dominated by a magnificent golden sun at its center, featuring a large circular disc from which emanate numerous wavy, flame-like rays that pulse with solar energy, while the background is divided into bold sections of varying blue shades, stark black, and pure white in diagonal and triangular patterns, with a smaller golden star in the upper left corner and another in the lower portion, all enclosed by a decorative rope or chain-like border. The central sun is the flag's unmistakable focal point, directly representing Aicruae's total devotion to Razar, the Sun God, and its identity as "The Land Under the Sun," with the flames suggesting both the divine fire of religious fervor and the agricultural abundance that allows Aicruae to produce 48% of the world's eggs, berries, rice, peaches, apples, carrots, chickens, beef, and leafy greens—crops nourished by sunlight. The multiple stars scattered across the composition suggest both celestial guidance and the divine blessings that supposedly allow the country to be "made new" after each war, leading some to believe the land itself is blessed. The rope border might represent the binding together of the 120 million people across Aicruae's many territories, or the chains of the rigid social hierarchy from the god-like King and Queen down through the Heirs, Consorts (whose existence as official mistresses is taboo), Dukes, Ashantis, government officials, knights, and peasants. The bold, dramatic divisions of color reflect both the nation's strong culture valuing family, community, and tradition passed down through oral history and song, and the contradictory reputation as a wealthy, neutral country that nonetheless cannot keep its own subjects in line—making it the "loose canon nation" and laughing stock among more stable powers, a duality embodied in the flag's combination of unified solar symbolism and fractured geometric sections.

Basic Information: Aicruae is called the land under the sun, and Aicruae was given this nickname because of both the beautiful climate of the region and the fact that the country is primarily devoted to the God Razar (The God of the Sun).

Capital: Lajazer

The Capital's Move: Before the country was officially founded, the capital/or central hub of the region that would later become Aicruae was located on the edge of the territory, along the western coast or border, possibly near what is now modern Hadiber in Western Aicruae. For a while this unofficial position of the capital was King Hailour Layern Patton I's stronghold because during The Warriors Age, a time of scattered warlords it was the best hope of a stable location. But once Aicruae was fully established and King Hailour Layern Patton I was able to actualize his goal of ushering in "peace" he moved the capital toward the more present location of Aicruae for three reasons. When Aicruae was moving towards being a kingdom, King Hailour Layern Patton I realized that an edge of the country capital was harder to defend, after an invasion scare the crown relocated to the center for better military position. Though this was the official reason given, a major part of the decision was the idea to put the capital, "on top of a giant mountain-like cliff" because of King Hailour Layern Patton I's dream of the two panthers, he deeply believed in this dream and the original capital predated the dream, and once Hailour had his vision he demanded relocation to the divinely-indicated site. A few had challenged him, saying his so-called dreams were the ravings of a mad man swayed by war and momentum until the economic shift happened. As Aicruae's economy developed the center became more important for trade routes, and a centrally located capital made more sense for administration of a fully fledged country. When King Hailour Layern Patton I destroyed all records before him, he sadly destroyed the old capital too, in an attempt to erase the previous era, and unfortunately no one knows what happened to the old capital. The old capital is likely to have been buried underneath modern Western Aicruae, and this might explain why this region is so productive since it was near a place that was once a center of power and received the best pre-founding infrastructure because of that.

Founded: [8,759 BR]

Founder: King Hailour Layern Patton I

Founding Information:

Aicruae was founded in 8,759 BR by King Hailour Layern Patton I of Aicruae during the Warriors Age after King Hailour Layern Patton I helped stop the era of violence taking place within the region that would become Aicruae by making peace with the local warlords of the time.

The region that makes up Aicruae history is covered in blood, due to the countless wars that have been waged on its soil, yet with each war, the country is made anew leaving many to believe the land is truly to have been blessed by the gods. Unfortunately not much is known about the country's history pre-founding, King Hailour Layern Patton I of Aicruae had all records destroyed which included almost all history of life in the region that would go on to become Aicruae before him and his dynasty.

GEOGRAPHY

GEOGRAPHY

Location: Far western edge of the continent

Borders:

North: Northern highlands and mountain ranges

South: Semi-arid badlands (Basar Tari region)

East: Pireaynea and Gherci

West: Quather Sea coastline

Major Bodies of Water:

- Quather Sea (western frontier)
- Fetora Sea (southwestern coast, shared with Vikitsv and Pireaynea)
- Numerous rivers and lakes throughout lowlands and valleys
- Crystal-clear highland lakes

Terrain Types:

- Northern highlands: Rugged mountains wreathed in mist and clouds, dense evergreen forests, alpine meadows
- Central heartland: Rolling hills, broad fertile valleys threaded with rivers and waterfalls

- Western lowlands: Gentle, extraordinarily fertile plains with hedgerows dividing expansive fields; fruit orchards mingle with farmland
- Southern reaches: Semi-arid badlands, rocky scrubland approaching the Fetora coast

Climate: Cool Temperate/Humid Continental Climate (Similar to real life Northern France, Southern Germany or the Northern United States.)

- Northern/Western regions: Temperate with warm summers and brisk, clear winters
- Southern regions: Hotter and drier, approaching semi-arid conditions
- Western lowlands: Long, intense summers; locals remark the sun “never leaves the sky”
- Northern Isles: Damp and cool due to steady ocean currents; humid but favorable

COASTLINES & ISLANDS

Western Coast (Quather Sea):

- Long, rich shoreline with natural harbors
- Mild oceanic climate supporting fishing villages and port towns

Southwestern Coast (Fetora Sea):

- Shorter and more sparsely populated
- Crucial maritime outlet toward eastern neighbors

Northern Isles:

- Large island and islets off Aicruae’s northwest coast
- Functions almost as a separate province
- Humid but prosperous, dominated by port towns and fishing communities
- Major towns: Aishae, Paler, Port Vento
- Famed for bountiful fisheries and thriving trade harbors

The Mystic Isles:

- Isolated archipelago far to the southwest, technically under Aicruae's nominal claim
- Never firmly colonized by any Aicruan king
- Local legend holds these lush isles are a sacred realm of the gods
- Many who venture there never return
- Left undisturbed by Aicruae's monarchs, adding an air of mystique

FORESTS & MOUNTAINS

Northern Mountains:

- Form a natural barrier and climate divide
- Peaks often wreathed in mist and clouds
- Dense evergreen forests and alpine meadows
- Provide timber, mineral resources, and protection from northern winds
- Many streams originate here, flowing south and west to nourish farmlands

Central Highlands:

- Teeming with wildlife: deer, boar, wolves, eagles nesting along craggy cliffs
- Ancient woods with diverse fauna

Western Lowlands:

- Forest thins into woodlots and hedgerows dividing expansive fields
- Fruit trees grow in abundance
- Broadleaf forests mingle with farmland
- Can be unforgiving in high summer; scorching heat waves contribute to high mortality among farm workers

FARMLANDS & VALLEYS

Distribution: Most of Aicruae's population lives in rural communities amid arable plains and river valleys, especially in the west and central-south.

Soil Quality: Rich alluvial soil and mild rainfall yield excellent harvests of grains, fruits, and vegetables.

The Aoner (Primary Agricultural Region):

- Known as the "Granary of the West"
- Single district produces nearly 48% of the world's supply of rice, peaches, apples, berries, carrots, leafy greens, eggs, chickens, and beef
- Countless small farms and massive estates
- Irrigated by pristine rivers flowing from the highlands

Seasonal Cycle:

- Spring floods rejuvenate the soil
- Long warm summers of toil
- Autumns full of harvest festivals
- Moderate winters allowing hardy winter crops to grow

Southern Frontier:

- Arable land gives way to rocky scrubland approaching the Fetora coast
- Largely uncultivated
- Known for housing Basar Tari (royal prison) and rumored ties to the UIB

NATIVE FLORA & FAUNA

WILDLIFE:

Forests & Mountains:

- Red deer and roe deer at forest edges
- Wild boar in underbrush
- Grey wolves in deeper woods and high ridges
- Black and brown bears in mountain foothills (growing rare as settlements expand)
- Foxes, hares, and badgers in wooded and rural areas
- Hawks and falcons riding mountain thermals

- Eagles nesting along craggy cliffs

Lowlands & Rural Areas:

- Rabbits in vegetable patches
- Songbirds among hedgerows
- Waterfowl flocking to numerous lakes

Coastal & Marine:

- Herring, cod, mackerel, and shellfish (basis of coastal diets)
- Pods of dolphins occasionally seen offshore

Domesticated Animals:

- Semi-wild horses in upland pastures (breeding of warhorses and draft horses is a proud tradition, perhaps owing to patronage of Paha, goddess of horses)
- Hardy breeds of cattle, sheep, goats, chickens, and pigs raised across the countryside

CROPS & PRODUCE:

Staple Grains:

- Wheat, barley, and rye carpet open plains
- Rice cultivated in well-watered river valleys (The Aoner produces ~ 48% of world's rice supply)

Fruits:

- Apples and pears in cooler highlands
- Peaches, plums, and cherries in sunnier lowlands
- Grape vineyards on certain hillsides (supporting local winemaking)
- Wild berries (strawberries, blackberries, blueberries) collected from forests

Vegetables:

- Cabbages, carrots, turnips, onions in kitchen gardens
- Potatoes (relatively new introduction)

- Legumes (peas and beans)
- Leafy greens (spinach and kale)

Specialty Crops:

- Flax for linen
- Hops for brewing
- Experimental tobacco and cotton in some southern plots (via imported seeds)
- Herbs for cooking and medicine

KEY LOCATIONS

-

Capital City:

Major Cities/Towns:

Strategic Locations:

Sacred Sites:

Inns & Lodging:

A. Infrastructure/Inn Services of Aicruae

- BASIC INFORMATION;Type: Traveler accommodations. Distribution: Along main roads and in settlements. Reliability: Varies by location and proximity to civilization.

1. SAFE INNS

- Main roads have established inns, often identified by carved signs (a bed, a cup, a horse). Inns near cities/towns are regulated and relatively trustworthy.Remote inns can be dicey. overcharging, bed bugs, occasionally working with bandits to rob travelers.Pilgrims to the Cidet have the best-maintained road and safest inns (the temple has interest in protecting pilgrims)

Road Conditions:

A. Road Systems of Aicruae: Infrastructure Network

- **BASIC INFORMATION;** Name: Road System of Aicruae. Type: Transportation Infrastructure. Nation: Aicruae. Coverage: Kingdom-wide, varying quality by region.

1. NOTES

- Pilgrims to the Cidet have the best-maintained road and safest inns (the temple has interest in protecting pilgrims)

1. DANGERS ON THE ROAD

- **Bandits:**Especially in Southern Aicruae (UIB connections) and the border with Pireaynea. Even main roads can be hit, but bandits prefer isolated stretches.
- **Wild Animals:** Wolves in forest regions, wild boar in the north. Bears in mountain areas. Usually avoid humans but can be dangerous if surprised or starving.
- **Weather:** Western Aicruae's heat kills travelers who don't carry enough water. Northern coastal areas can have sudden storms.
- **Getting Lost:** Without signposts (which only exist on main roads), travelers can wander for days.
- **Local Hostility:** Some villages don't welcome strangers, especially in isolated areas. Travelers without obvious House badges or merchant credentials might be turned away.

3. ROAD CLASSIFICATIONS

- **Main Roads (Capital-to-Port routes):**Well-maintained, paved or packed stone, patrolled by royal soldiers.

Relatively safe. Inns every 15-20 miles (a day's walk or half-day's ride). Bridges maintained by toll-keepers.

- **Secondary Roads (between smaller towns):**Packed dirt, maintained by local nobles. Quality varies wildly. House Arvento territory has excellent roads; House Hige territory probably has poor ones. Fewer patrols; more bandit risk.
- **Rural Paths:**Barely more than footpaths. No maintenance. Used by locals who know them.

Outsiders risk getting lost.

POPULATION

-

Total Population: 120 Million People

Gender Breakdown: 49% Female, 51% Male.

Ethnic Composition:

[Barie]: [30%] Barie people (People with typically light to fair skin tones, sometimes with pink or cool undertones. Their noses are often narrow or straight-bridged; the tip may be pointed or softly rounded. Their eyes are usually deep-set with defined eyelid creases in colors like blue, green, grey, hazel, or light brown. Their hair texture is usually straight or wavy and the colors range anywhere from blonde to brown to black to red. With an angular or softly squared jawline, thinner lips that can sometimes be moderately full, cheekbones range from high to mid-set.)

[Taili]: [55%] Taili people (People with medium-brown to deep brown skintone that may have warm, olive cool or neutral undertones. Their nose shapes are often broad, curved, rounded, straight or gently flared with the bridge height depending on the region. Their eye shape is often almond shaped or round with their eyelids appearing with a subtle or less pronounced crease but a defined crease is not completely uncommon. Their eye colors are typically lighter to darker brown, sometimes even black similar to that of Guio's, and Nemeris. Their hair texture is typically tightly coiled/tightly curled though density and curl pattern vary widely. Their lips are often full or softly rounded. Their cheekbones may be prominent, their jawlines can be rounded, angular or square.)

[Nemeris]: [13%] Nemeris people (People with light golden to deep brown skin tones, with warm to golden undertones though neutral and cool undertones are not uncommon. Their nose shape is usually straight, softly rounded, or slightly broad. Their eye shape is commonly almond shaped. Their eye colors are typically lighter to darker brown, sometimes even black similar to that of Guio's, and Taili's. Their hair is usually straight, wavy or loosely curled, usually black or dark brown similar to Guio's. Their lips are within the medium-full to full range. Their cheekbones are softly defined or prominent, while their jawlines can be rounded and or angular.)

[Guio]: [2%] Guio people (People with typically fair to medium skin tones, with cool neutral or warm undertones. Their eye shape is often almond-shaped, their eyelids have a monolid, or a subtle crease. Their nose shape is usually straight or softly rounded. Their hair is usually straight, wavy or loosely curled, usually black or dark brown similar to Nemeris. Lips are usually medium-full to full. Their lips are within the medium-full to full range. Their cheekbones are softly defined or prominent, while their jawlines can be rounded and or angular.)

Population Density:

Major Population Centers:

GOVERNMENT

Government Type:

Current Ruler (By Era):

Solis's Era:

Crandon's Era:

Minara's Era:

Power Structure:

1. King/Queen [The Rulers of Aicruae bow their heads to no one within the country and are essentially treated like gods]
2. Princes/Princess/ Heirs to the Throne [Second to the King and The Queen of Aicruae are the heirs to the throne, they are also deeply revered]
3. Consort/Concubines of the Royal Family [The Consort/Concubine is an official mistress/lover brought in by the king/queen, he or she is hailed lower than the heirs because having a mistress is seen as extremely taboo in Aicruae. A consort/concubine is not allowed to be legally married to the ruler and is therefore a grey area between royal and regular noble authority.]
4. Extended members of the royal family[Better known as Des, is a term meaning "distant relative" and is a playful twist on the usual word Der. Unlike Der, Des is a title reserved exclusively for those who carry a viable trace of royal blood belonging to the royal family of Aicruae. It's considered a more formal and respectful version of Der, used only for those with royal lineage.]
5. Duke/Duchess [This is the highest rank a noble can receive within the class hierarchy of Aicruae without having to be a King/Queen or a direct member of

the royal family.]

6. Lower-Level Nobles [These are the noble ranks that fall below that of a Duke or Duchess, these people still carry noble blood but compared to the status of a Duke/Duchess this group of people would be considered lower-level Nobles. These people are usually referred to as Ashanti's (people who own land and rule over that land in which they own).]
7. High Government Officials [High Government Officials are people who are lawyers, guards, and enforcers of the Law of the Royal Family. These people are different from knights because unlike knights high government officials get to have an audience with the king and act as supervisors to the common citizens of the kingdom as well as the knights of the kingdom.]
8. Knights [People tasked with protecting nobles and the royal family. They make up a large percentage of the Laborers in Aicruae and operate to secure the Kingdom from all threats.]
9. Peasants [Aicruae is a wealthy country, to say the least, but regardless the country still has peasants most of whom work for high-ranking nobles as maids or servants, and the others who are either unhoused or partaking in back door ways of making money like their noble counterparts.]

Laws:

1. Justice & Conflict Resolution- Legal System
2. BASIC INFORMATION; Aicruae's Legal Framework
3. Name: Justice & Conflict Resolution System.
4. Type: Multi-tiered legal framework. Nation: [Aicruae].
5. Governing Philosophy: Code of Esa, "just punishment" reflects crime severity.

VILLAGE-LEVEL DISPUTE RESOLUTION ;

- First Level: Family/Community Mediation Most disputes never reach any official; families handle it themselves Village elders (usually oldest male heads of household) gather to hear both sides mostly focused on restoring the

common harmony, not punishment. Common resolutions: public apology, labor exchange, shared meals, small payments

Example (fence line dispute): Two farmers argue over where one's field ends and another's begins. Both families meet with village elders. Oldest residents who remember the original boundaries are consulted. Physical evidence examined (old fence posts, tree lines). Decision is made; losing party must accept publicly. Both parties share a meal and the matter is "buried". If either party refuses resolution, then it escalates.

- Second Level: Temple Arbitration Local priests (who are respected and theoretically neutral) can mediate Swearing oaths before the gods this carries serious weight because Priests more often than not impose religious penalties: extra offerings, pilgrimage, public penance. This is free but carries spiritual obligation.
- Third Level: Noble Court The Ashanti (land-owning noble) of the territory holds court Cases brought here are recorded (if the noble keeps records) The noble's decision is legally binding Costs: petitioners usually bring gifts/payments; this favors the wealthy Punishments can include fines, labor, corporal punishment, or imprisonment
- Fourth Level: Higher Noble or Royal Courts Only for serious crimes or appeals from wealthy parties Commoners almost never reach this level Reserved for: murder, theft of significant value, crimes involving multiple territories, anything touching noble interests

1. Criminal Punishments in Practice - Legal System (Based on Code of Esa Framework)

- Crimes Against the State (treason, sedition, blasphemy):
 - A. Public execution, often elaborate (Vono Vika having tongues ripped out; the Massacre of Light).
 - B. Entire families can be punished for treason, usually male members of the family are executed, and female members are banished/exiled or forced into some form of slavery.
 - C. Property seized by the crown
- Serious Crimes (murder, rape, major theft, arson):
 - A. Execution (beheading is standard; burning for heresy or treason)

- B. Life imprisonment with hard labor
- C. Exile to the southern prison colony at Basar Tari
- D. Mutilation (hand amputation for thieves, tongue removal for perjurers)
- Moderate Crimes (significant theft, assault causing injury, fraud):
 - A. Fines and restitution to victim
 - B. Imprisonment (weeks to months) with hard labor
 - C. Corporal punishment: whipping, the cangue (wooden collar worn publicly).

Branding for repeat offenders.

- Petty Crimes (theft of food, minor assault, public drunkenness):
 - A. First offense: Public shaming (stocks, wearing a sign), fines, or whipping (5-20 lashes)
 - B. Repeat offense: Branding on hand or face, longer whipping, short imprisonment
- SPECIAL CIRCUMSTANCES;
 - A. Nobles: Tried by peers, rarely face corporal punishment; more likely imprisonment, exile, or stripping of titles.
 - B. Clerics, Members of The Cidet Etc: Clerics: Tried by religious courts first; may be handed to secular authorities after.
 - C. House Vika's Territory (Haleker): Punishments in Haleker are best described as "brutish"; harsher than elsewhere, faster, with less process.
- OTHER NOTES:
 - > A. The Council of the Forsaken: Created by House Arvento, Aedria, and Caraen to investigate violent crimes. The Council of the Forsaken has the king's (crown's) approval and can investigate across territories. They have brought the crime rate down to 30% since their founding. Are "greatly feared" Have significant authority to arrest, interrogate, and possibly execute.
 - > 1. Poison Kan: Created by Sina Arvento specifically for executing "those convicted of horrendous acts such as rape or murder". It takes 2 hours to kill. Represents painful, slow death for heinous crimes. One reminder of House Arvento's authority to create and use execution methods.

Noble Houses: 13 Noble Houses Notable Houses and Some Minor Noble Houses as well

Political Factions:

Aicruae Noble Houses/Noble Houses of Aicruae/ Political Fractions

1. Divine Fraction : Wants the monarchy and the nobility class system. Believe that it was their Divine right to be born nobles: House Patton, House Vika, House Vemer, House Kulio, House Najil, House Hige
2. Neutral Fraction : Each of these Houses shares the values of both sides: House Arvento, House Mena, House Caraen, House Aedria.
3. Common People Fraction : Hates the monarchy and the class system overall: House Leva, House Dajanyi, House Yurea.

Minor Nobles (Relevant to the story but background Houses)

1. House Yainaro - Divine Fraction
2. House Miada - Divine Fraction
3. House Tikan - Divine Fraction
4. House Anaiopana - Divine Fraction
5. House Hert - Divine Fraction
6. House Brumik - Common People Fraction
7. House Cowsrer - Common People Fraction
8. House Kilina - Common People Fraction
9. House Kauliv - Divine Fraction
10. House Gaset - Common People Fraction

ECONOMY

Currency: 1 Rern = ~ \$20 USD

Primary Industries: Fishing, Farming, and Trading

- These three primary industries alone help generate upwards of 150 Billion Rern Yearly for Aicruae. (Using the conversion that is 150 Billion (The Value in Rern) multiplied by 20 (The value in USD), which means Aicruae on average in USD is making roughly 3 Trillion dollars yearly.

Major Exports: 1] Fish via towns like Aishae, Paler, and Vento, 2] Fabrics/Clothing via towns like Haleker and 3] Meat, Fruits, Vegetables, Wheat via towns like

Hadiber, Melert and The Aoner.

- The Aoner alone produces 48% of the world's Eggs, Berries, Rice, Peaches, Apples, Carrots, Chickens, Beef, and leafy greens among other things.

Major Imports:

Wealth Distribution:

1. Top 1% (Royal Family, Dukes, Wealthiest Merchants): Control 45 – 50% of national wealth
2. Next 9% (Lower Nobles, High Officials, Successful Merchants): Control 25 – 30% of national wealth
3. Middle 40% (Knights, Traders, Landowning Farmers, Skilled Workers): Control 18 – 22% of national wealth
4. Bottom 50% (Common Laborers, Fishermen, Tenant Farmers, Peasants): Control 3 – 7% of national wealth

Annual Income by Class:

1. King/Queen: 50, 000, 000 – 100, 000, 000 Rern/year (\$1-2 billion USD)
2. Princes/Princesses/Heirs: 10, 000, 000 – 25, 000, 000 Rern/year (\$200 – 500 million USD)
3. Consorts/Concubines: 5, 000, 000 – 15, 000, 000 Rern/year (\$100-300 million USD)
4. Des (Extended Royal Family): 1, 000, 000 – 5, 000, 000 Rern/year (\$20-100 million USD)
5. Duke/Duchess: 500,000-2,000,000 Rern/year (\$10-40 million USD)
6. Lower-Level Nobles (Ashanti's): 50,000-500,000 Rern/year (\$1-10 million USD)
7. High Government Officials (Piesto): 5,000-20,000 Rern/year (\$100,000-400,000 USD)
8. Wealthy Merchants/Business Owners: 3,000-15,000 Rern/year (\$60,000-300,000 USD)
9. Knights: 1,500-3,000 Rern/year (\$30,000-60,000 USD)

10. Successful Traders/Blacksmiths: 1,200-2,500 Rern/year (\$24,000-50,000 USD)
11. Average Merchants: 800-1,500 Rern/year (\$16,000-30,000 USD)
12. Farmers (small landowners): 600-1,000 Rern/year (\$12,000-20,000 USD)
13. Fishermen: 500-900 Rern/year (\$10,000-18,000 USD)
14. Common Laborers: 400-700 Rern/year (\$8,000-14,000 USD)
15. Peasants (servants/maids): 200-400 Rern/year (\$4,000-8,000 USD)
16. Peasants (struggling/unhoused): 50-200 Rern/year (\$1,000-4,000 USD)

Job Economy:

Farmers: 35%

Fisherman: 20%

Official/Nobles/Ashanti's: 5%

Piesto[Lawyers, Guards/Enforcers of the law]: 3%

Merchants/Business Owners/Traders/Blacksmiths: 28%

Laborer/Common Worker: 9%

ECONOMIC - BUSINESS

- The UIB (Underground Illegal Business): [Type: Criminal Organization Network].
1. The UIB (Underground Illegal Business). Also known as the UIB, is a criminal network that is primarily in Southern Aicruae, but has influence throughout the kingdom.
 2. The UIB isn't one organization. It's a loose network of criminal enterprises operating primarily in Southern Aicruae, with influence throughout the kingdom. Think of it like a combination of: Organized crime families, Smuggling networks, Black markets, Loan sharks and underground banking.
 3. The UIB has no single leader, there are multiple competing groups with territorial agreements. Local "bosses" control specific towns or trade routes in Southern Aicruae.

4. Basar Tari, is the unofficial hub of this organization most guards and officials have been silently corrupted, allowing from the creation of a criminal hub right under the crown's nose supposedly.
5. The UIB is known for trading things like: Prohibited Goods; Joyless Death poison (produced by House Vika but probably sold illegally through UIB), Stone Powder (A drug that is legally banned in Aicruae but is still sold through the UIB haven been imported from Equateiy).Other poisons and dangerous substances.Stolen goods fenced through UIB-connected merchants.Forged documents (noble patents, merchant licenses, land deeds).Smuggled Goods (avoiding taxes); Luxury items from foreign countries (gems from Equateiy, goods from Vikitsv), Untaxed alcohol, Goods from Pireaynea that would otherwise have tariffs. Services; Assassination (for those who can't afford or access House Vika's legitimate services),Kidnapping and ransom,Information brokering (secrets, blackmail material),Illegal gambling operations,Prostitution networks. Human Trafficking;Selling servants/workers across borders, Debt bondage.
6. House Yurea and House Vemer in Southern Aicruae on the surface appear to be legitimate nobles, but those two noble houses have disclosed ties to the UIB, members of both of House Yurea and House Vemer have members secretly involved with the businesses, which means that they tolerate the UIB activity in exchange for bribes, on the surface the official reasoning given is that they're too weak to stop the UIB activities and must pretend it doesn't exist for the overall well being of the territory. But outside of House Yurea and House Vemer, some merchants in other regions buy UIB-sourced goods knowingly, and Nobles occasionally use UIB services (assassinations, acquiring banned items), even House Leva (with their "King's thieves" reputation) have historical connections, House Dajanyi (former pirates) knows the networks even if they're now legitimate.
7. Part of the reason why the UIB is able to persist is also because Southern Aicruae is described as "barren wasteland with nothing to offer". The legitimate economy is very weak, so crime fills the vacuum. The prison draws desperate people (families of prisoners, released convicts with no options, sometimes the only option is slipping back into the very institution that caused your pain, when you are hungry and starving.) And the distance from Lajazer

doesn't help since it means less crown oversight. Again, the crime "in Southern Aicruae runs more rampant than anywhere else" and people are leaving for Western Aicruae. The crown has essentially written off the south unofficially.

ECONOMIC- SOCIAL GROUP

- Traveling Merchants : Type: Commercial travelers. Function: Trade and goods transport. Operating Area: Throughout Aicruae.
1. Operations & Practices: Usually travel in caravans for safety. Hire guards (often former soldiers or House Vika-trained mercenaries). Know which inns to trust and which to avoid. Have their own network of information about road conditions.

MILITARY

Military Strength:

Army Composition:

Notable Military Traditions:

Strategic Advantages:

Weaknesses:

RELIGION

-

Primary Religion:

God(s) Worshipped:

Religious Institutions:

Clergy Structure:

Religious Tensions:

CULTURE

-

Defining Values:

Education:

- A. For Commoners: Almost none in the formal sense.
- B. Temple teaching: The Cidet and local Peknas (triangular temples) offer basic religious instruction. Children learn prayers, the names and stories of the twelve gods, and moral teachings from the Code of Esa.
- C. Oral tradition: History, practical knowledge, and values are passed through songs and stories.
- D. Literacy: Extremely rare among peasants. Maybe 5% can recognize their own name or count with numbers. Merchants have higher literacy (necessary for business).
- E. Noble Children: Private tutors from age 4 -5 Learn reading, writing, mathematics, history, religious texts. Boys: martial training, estate management, politics. Girls: household management, music, embroidery, religious studies, some literacy. Both genders learn dancing and court etiquette.

Social Customs:

A. What Children Do Before Working Age: Note this applies to Children not born into Nobility, Noble Children do not work and such an act is seen as deeply shameful.

- Ages 0-5: Cared for primarily by mothers, grandmothers, or older siblings. Peasant women often work with infants strapped to their backs. Toddlers play in dirt; no formal "toys" but carved wooden animals, cloth dolls, pebble games. Early religious teaching: learning the names of gods, basic prayers.
- Ages 5-8: Begin "helper" tasks: fetching water, feeding animals, carrying messages. Girls start learning domestic skills: basic cooking, spinning. Boys shadow fathers in fields or workshops. This is when most children learn songs, dances, and oral stories.
- Ages 8-12: Considered capable of real work. Farm children work half-days in fields. Fishing children help on shore (not yet on boats; too dangerous). Craft children begin apprenticeships.

WILDLIFE:

Forests & Mountains:

- Red deer and roe deer at forest edges

- Wild boar in underbrush
- Grey wolves in deeper woods and high ridges
- Black and brown bears in mountain foothills (growing rare as settlements expand)
- Foxes, hares, and badgers in wooded and rural areas
- Hawks and falcons riding mountain thermals
- Eagles nesting along craggy cliffs

Lowlands & Rural Areas:

- Rabbits in vegetable patches
- Songbirds among hedgerows
- Waterfowl flocking to numerous lakes

Coastal & Marine:

- Herring, cod, mackerel, and shellfish (basis of coastal diets)
- Pods of dolphins occasionally seen offshore
- Semi-wild horses in upland pastures (breeding of warhorses and draft horses is a proud tradition, perhaps owing to patronage of Paha, goddess of horses)
- Hardy breeds of cattle, sheep, goats, chickens, and pigs raised across the countryside

CROPS & PRODUCE:

Staple Grains:

- Wheat, barley, and rye carpet open plains
- Rice cultivated in well-watered river valleys (The Aoner produces ~ 48% of world's rice supply)

Fruits:

- Apples and pears in cooler highlands
- Peaches, plums, and cherries in sunnier lowlands
- Grape vineyards on certain hillsides (supporting local winemaking)

- Wild berries (strawberries, blackberries, blueberries) collected from forests

Vegetables:

- Cabbages, carrots, turnips, onions in kitchen gardens
- Potatoes (relatively new introduction)
- Legumes (peas and beans)
- Leafy greens (spinach and kale)

Specialty Crops:

- Flax for linen
- Hops for brewing
- Experimental tobacco and cotton in some southern plots (via imported seeds)
- Herbs for cooking and medicine

CULTURE

Defining Values: Social harmony, religious observance, deference to hierarchy, modesty and temperance

Gender Roles:

- Patriarchal society with nuances by class
 - Men dominate politics, scholarship, and warfare
- Noble sons train as knights or administrators; common men work fields or crafts
- Women manage home and family lineage
- Noblewomen: Supervise large estates, serve as advisors or regents, lead courtly life; receive formal education in religion, literature, and etiquette
- Common women: Labor alongside men in farming, weaving, and local trade; teach children the faith
- Society prizes feminine modesty and virtue

- Women can legally inherit property if male kin die (strengthened by Saint Siriande's Yerian Laws)
- Top military and governmental posts reserved for men
- Women rarely wield overt political authority except as queens, mother superiors, or abbesses

Customs and Taboos:

Deference:

- Common people must kowtow before the king
- Nobles must perform deep bows (women curtsy) when greeting higher nobility
- Direct eye contact or idle speech in presence of superiors is taboo

Sumptuary Laws:

- Commoners forbidden from wearing silks, gold, or certain dyes reserved for nobles
- Only royalty may bear certain emblems (the sun motif is royal)
-Violating clothing laws is a crime

Religious Observance:

- People give offerings before meals
- Seek omens from sacrificial signs
- Fast on solemn holidays (breaking fasts may incur communal scorn)
- Commoners address nobles with formal third-person blessings, invoking Razar's light as salutation

Hygiene:

Aicruae uses herbs such as peppermint, rosemary etc as deodorant. In some rural parts of Aicruae they would grind rosemary, peppermint or whatever scented herbs they had into a powder and use their hands to work the powder into their armpits or whatever places they might need to not stink. In the more wealthy areas or noble houses they would opt for a peppermint/rosemary or in more finer houses Vinalla or more "exotic" fragrances in an oil form, so instead of powder the

would use the scented oil version that would last longer and wouldn't be as difficult to work with.

Social Conduct:

- Cursing the king or insulting the pantheon is a crime; blasphemy draws severe punishment
- Alcohol allowed but drunkenness socially frowned upon (Circle's teaching of temperance)
- Disputes often settled privately through mediation by elders or priests to avoid public scandal
- Nobles and clergy enjoy legal immunities (tried by peers)

INFRASTRUCTURE & TRADE ROUTES

ROAD NETWORKS:

Grand Trunk Road:

- Main artery from the old western capital site (near modern Hadiber) through Lajazer and eastward to Haleker
- Paved or well-packed, allowing horse-drawn carts to traverse even mountainous sections

Regional Connections:

- Northward: Causeway and ferry system connecting mainland to Northern Isles
- Southward: Roads to Basar Tari and small Fetora seaside outposts (less traveled, primarily for moving troops or convicts)
- Western farmlands: Countless country lanes linking estates to market towns; stone bridges and drainage ditches keep grain wagons rolling
- Eastern road to Haleker: Militarily important supply line to Pireaynea border; fortified with patrol stations and walls

MARITIME ROUTES:

Major Ports: Port Vento, Aishae, Paler (docks for fishing fleets and merchant galleys, warehouses, lively bazaars)

Shipping Routes:

- Southward across Fetora Sea to Vikitsv and Pireaynea coasts (sometimes favored to avoid overland banditry through Pireaynea)
- Westward into open Quather Sea
- Long-distance voyages around continent's southern cape to reach Obery Sea, trading with Equateiy and Vikitsv

River Transport: Barges carry grain and timber downstream to coastal ports

STRATEGIC CORRIDORS:

Aicruae-Gherci Corridor:

- Primary overland route linking Aicruae to eastern states passes through Gherci and Pireaynea
- Whoever controls this corridor controls trade between western coast and central/eastern continent
- Pireaynea's lawlessness ("the Demon's Pit") puts caravans at constant risk
- Aicruae and Gherci cooperate on securing this route; fortified caravanserais established along

Pireaynea road

Pilgrimage Road to the Cidet:

- Well-maintained pilgrim road from Lajazer southward to the Cidet
- Patrolled by Aicruan guards to protect pious travelers
- Steady stream of pilgrims brings additional commerce (inns, markets, guide services)

Greeting Customs:

Marriage Customs:

Funeral Customs:

Festivals:

A. Festival Activities:

- The Ansari and Cartose dances
- Tal-Sel (wedding/festival dance)
- Competitive events: wrestling, foot races, archery
- Eating and drinking competitions
- Poetry recitation (among educated classes)

Fashion:

Entertainment:

Food & Cuisine:

A. Common People:

- Western Aicruae (Farming Region):

Breakfast: Leftover grain porridge, perhaps with berries or a boiled egg (eggs are plentiful here).

Midday (Main Meal): Bread, cheese, vegetables, possibly fish if near a river.

Evening: Soup, bread, whatever's left. Mid-morning: Water and dried fruit.

- Northern Aicruae (Fishing Region):

Pre-Dawn: Cold fish and bread; a sip of weak ale

Lunch: Fresh fish grilled over driftwood fires (often eaten standing)

Generally: Slightly better food than other commoners due to greater wealth

B. Nobles/Role Family:

GREETING CUSTOMS IN THE KINGDOM OF AICRUAЕ (Era of Solis)

The Kingdom of Aicruae (prior to its absorption into the Solisian Empire) observed elaborate greeting customs reflecting its stratified society and devout culture.

Greetings were highly ritualized to show respect according to social hierarchy, influenced by Aicruae's native traditions.

QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE:

Who is Greeting	Required Gesture	Verbal Address
Whom		
Commoner → Monarch	Full prostration (forehead to floor) or three kneelings	"Your Majesty" "Your Majesty, the reflection of the moon itself (For the Queen),
		"Your Majesty, the reflection of the sun itself (For the King)
Commoner → Prince/Princess	Deep bow or kneel	"Your Royal Highness" Your royal highness the blank (If its the first born prince you would say the first sun, if its the second born prince you would say the second sun and so on.) Sun " "Your royal highness the blank (If its the first born princess you would say the first moon, if its the

second born princess you would say the second moon and so on.) Moon.

Noble → Monarch	Deep bow (men) or deep curtsy to one knee (women)	"Your Majesty" "Usually a praise followed by Your Majesty."
Noble → Prince/Princess	Deep curtsy/bow, eyes lowered	"Your Royal Highness" "Usually a praise followed by Your Majesty."
Lower Noble → Higher	Medium bow/curtsy (~ 30°)	"Lord Duke," "Lady
Noble		Countess," etc.
Equal Nobles	Shallow mutual bow	Proper titles on first meeting
Commoner → Noble	Deep waist bow or kneel on one knee	"My Lord/Lady"
Younger → Elder (any class)	Bow + hand-kiss-to-forehead (traditional)	"Uncle/Aunt" (even if not related)
Peers/Friends (commoners)	Head nod, wave, or forearm clasp	Peace be with you or one person might say the phrase

to go, and the other person(s) respond with to meet again.

PART I: FORMAL COURT ETIQUETTE (Palace Protocols)

At court, greetings serve as ceremonial displays of loyalty and respect. The royal family stands at the apex of this system - Aicruae's kings and queens "bow their heads to no one" and are treated virtually as living divinities.

A. GREETING THE MONARCH AND ROYAL FAMILY

Approaching the Throne:

- Anyone of lower status (nobles and especially commoners) approaching the King, Queen, or royal heirs must do so slowly and in silence

- Stop at a respectful distance (several paces away) before initiating any gesture
- Typically, one is brought before the monarch by a herald
- Unsummoned approach is forbidden

Prostration and Bowing:

- COMMONERS: Perform full prostration - kneeling on both knees, bowing until forehead nearly (or literally) touches the floor. In the most solemn ceremonies, three kneelings and nine prostrations (a "threefold kowtow") are performed
- NOBLES (high rank): May be allowed a less extreme bow - kneeling on one knee or a very deep waist bow rather than full prostration
- NOBLEWOMEN: Execute a deep curtsy - drawing one foot behind the other, bending knees deeply, lowering head, sometimes coming down to one knee if the occasion is very formal
- In all cases, the head is kept bowed low in the monarch's presence

Waiting for Acknowledgment:

- The lower-ranked person must NOT speak or rise until addressed or given leave by the royal
- After bowing, maintain silence
- A young or lower-status person never greets an elder or superior first - they enter quietly and wait
- Only when the royal says "You may rise" or gives a nod of permission can they lift their head and offer verbal greeting

Verbal Address and Honorifics:

- Use exalted titles: "Your Majesty" (King/Queen) or "Your Royal Highness" (princes/princesses)
- Direct names are avoided
- Typical greeting phrased in third person or as a blessing

- Example: "Your Royal Highness, this humble lady offers greetings and prays for your glory under Razar's light."
- Common formal salutation: "May the sun shine eternal upon Your Majesty" (equivalent to wishing long life and prosperity)
- Refer to oneself in modest terms ("this humble lady," "your loyal servant")
- All speech is courteous, restrained, soft, and reverent

Physical Gestures by Royalty:

- The monarch or royal family member does NOT bow to subjects
- The King or Queen might give a slight nod, extend a hand, or simply look upon the person to acknowledge them
- If a royal extends a hand: the noble should lightly touch the back of it with their lips, then place their own hand over their heart as they withdraw
- If no hand is offered: remain in low bow or curtsy until told to rise
- Royals typically speak first; if they remain silent, the audience is over or the approach is unwelcome

Kissing the Floor or Hem (Extreme Obeisance):

- Used in cases of extraordinary supplication or when commoners present petitions
- The greeter may kiss the ground at the monarch's feet
- Traditionally done by those of the very lowest status (e.g., a prisoner begging for mercy, or a "slave" offering devotion)
- The individual might be permitted to advance on knees and kiss the monarch's foot, robe hem, or hand if the monarch signals approval
- Touching one's forehead to the floor is the absolute sign of obeisance - used sparingly

B. NOBLES GREETING ROYALTY (Example: Lady Emillea and Prince Orcus/Princess Iris)

Depth of Bow/Curtsey:

- A noblewoman performs a graceful but deep curtsey
- She would spread her skirts and lower until one knee nearly touches the floor, keeping her back straight and head bowed
- A nobleman would drop to one knee with head inclined, or execute a very deep bow from the waist
- General rule: the higher the rank of the person you greet, the lower you bow

Waiting and Eye Contact:

- Must wait to be addressed just as a commoner would
- Keep eyes lowered, not meeting the royal gaze until allowed
- It is disrespectful to make direct eye contact with royalty unless they engage you
- Only after the royal says "Rise, Lady Emillea" can she straighten up (to a modestly bowed posture) and look at their face
- Never interrupt; respond only after the royal finishes speaking

Verbal Etiquette:

- Use honorifics and third-person references
- Example: "Your Highness honors me with your attention" or "It is my privilege to serve"
- May avoid "I" and say "your loyal servant" or use their title: "Lady Emillea humbly greets Your Highness"
- Include well-wishes appropriate to the situation (congratulating on a victory, offering blessings of health)
- Compliments couched in flowery language: "Your Highness's presence is as the dawn bringing light to all around"
- Should not be overly familiar

Physical Interaction:

- Unless invited, a noble does NOT touch a royal
- If prince extends his hand: kiss his hand or knuckles lightly
- For a princess: take her hand and dip head as if kissing it (often not actually touching lips to skin, out of respect)
- A prince might gently lift a noblewoman from her kneel by the hand; she would thank him for his grace

Stepping Back:

- After the exchange, step aside or backward while bowing head again to signify the audience is ending
- Turning one's back directly on royalty is frowned upon
- Back away a few steps before turning to leave

C. GREETINGS AMONG NOBLES AT COURT

Hierarchy Determines Initiative:

- The lower-ranking noble should initiate the bow and greeting toward a higher-ranking noble
- A Knight or Baron must bow first when encountering a Duke/Duchess
- The higher noble returns a more subtle nod or abbreviated bow
- A Duchess will wait to see a Countess bow first; the Duchess then inclines her head in reply

Bows and Curtseys (Noble-to-Noble):

- Lower-ranked noble performs a respectful bow or curtsy (not as deep as one given to royalty)
- Example: A Baron meeting a Duke gives a medium-deep bow (about 30° from the waist) or knee-bend curtsy, with eyes lowered, saying "Lord Duke"

- The Duke responds with a slight nod and "Baron"
- If nobles are roughly equal rank: both exchange simultaneous, shallow bows with polite smiles or handshakes
- In formal events, even equals maintain decorum by bowing rather than shaking hands
- Physical contact (handshakes, embraces) minimized in throne room or ceremonies

Address and Titles:

- Address each other by proper titles and family names on first greeting: "Lady Aria of House Talwen, well met"
- Use honorifics: "my Lord," "my Lady"
- Using just a first name at court is disrespectfully informal unless intimate friends of equal rank
- Correct formal greeting: "Sir Balian, it is an honor" (with bow) → "Lady Meriste, the honor is mine" (returning bow)

Court Etiquette Formalities:

- When greeting high-ranking noble or royal in a corridor, a lesser noble will pause, step aside, and bow to let the superior pass (yielding the path)
- When nobles are presented at court, they line up by rank and each performs the required bow in turn
- A Master of Ceremonies oversees protocol to ensure correct order and depth of bow

Gender Differences:

- In mixed-company formal greetings: men bow, women curtsy
- A gentleman greeting a lady of equal or higher rank executes a crisp bow and says "My Lady"
- The lady responds with a slight nod or curtsy if the man is higher rank

- Gentlemen do NOT extend a hand to a lady unless she offers hers first
- Do not presume familiarity
- The woman in a social greeting is often treated as having courtesy precedence - the man waits for her cues
- If nobleman and noblewoman of similar rank meet: the man inclines his head and waits; if she extends her hand or greets him, he may then fully bow and respond
- Considered ungallant for a man to force a greeting on a lady who wishes to remain formally reserved

Royal Presence:

- When royalty is present, all nobles collectively show deference
- Conversation volume hushes when King or Queen enters
- Nobles bow as a group
- A noble must NOT call out a greeting to a royal casually
- In the throne room, even two dukes greeting each other do so in low tones with decorum
- Internal hierarchy among nobles never overshadows the ultimate authority of the monarch

A. COMMONERS GREETING COMMONERS

Friendly and Informal Greetings (Among Peers/Friends):

- A simple verbal greeting and light gesture suffice
- Common phrase: "Peace be with you"
- Also: "Good day" with a smile
- Typical gesture: light bow of head or casual wave

- Among close friends or relatives (especially men): clasping of forearms or brief embrace (hugging shoulders)
- Women friends: gentle hug or clasp hands
- Done with genuine smiles and inquiries about health: "How do you fare today?"

Respectful Bows for Elders:

- When younger commoner greets older person or person of esteem (village elder, teacher): tone becomes more respectful
- Younger offers a deeper nod or slight bow at the waist
- Address elders first with honorific: "Uncle Gan, peace be upon you" (even if not literally family)
- Terms like "Uncle/Aunt" used as respectful address for elders
- TRADITIONAL GESTURE: Young person may kiss the back of elder's hand, then touch it to their own forehead
- This means "Blessed be thee"
- Accompanied by verbal blessing: "May the light keep you healthy"
- Elder typically pats younger's shoulder or says kind word in return
- This hand-kiss-to-forehead custom is deeply ingrained - children do it to parents each morning in traditional households

Hierarchy and Deference:

- Positions like guild leaders, priests, wealthy merchants carry social weight
- A poorer/lower-status person greets a rich merchant or revered priest almost like a noble with pronounced bow and honorifics ("Master," "Father," "Revered One")
- Example: A farmer meeting the High Priestess bows deeply and says "Blessings, Revered Mother"

- The priestess might lay a hand on farmer's head in benediction rather than bowing back
- Among equals, such flowery manners unnecessary - two farmers may just grin and clap each other on the back

The Fist-and-Palm Salute (Traditional/Formal):

- A unique gesture seen during festivals or between polite strangers
- Place one hand in a fist and cup it in the other hand at chest level, then give a short bow
- MEN: cover the right fist with the left palm
- WOMEN: do the opposite
- Used for: An old-fashioned way of greeting. Became popular during a time of plagues when people could not interact normally out of fear of the plague spreading but still had to show respect.
- non-religious way to show respect without kneeling
- Example: A traveling merchant greets a village headman with this salute, saying "Peace and prosperity to you"
- Conveys sincerity and respect gracefully
- Considered slightly formal or old-fashioned - mostly preserved for ceremonial kindness or when two strangers want to show mutual respect (like two scholars meeting for the first time)

B. COMMONERS GREETING NOBLES

Immediate Deference:

- The instant a commoner recognizes a noble's presence, they stop what they are doing and acknowledge the noble
- Stand up if seated
- Remove any hat or head covering

- Perform a deep bow (at least 45° from the waist, or full bow with torso parallel to ground)
- If outdoors/informal (lord riding through town): step aside, bow deeply, say nothing unless addressed
- In more personal meeting (peasant summoned before lord): may go down to one knee while bowing head as sign of fealty

Verbal Address:

- Must use noble's proper title and respectful greeting phrase
- Examples: "Good day, Milord Duke" or "Your Lordship, I am at your service"
- Often refer to themselves humbly, sometimes in third person: "This humble servant thanks My Lady for her kindness"
- If commoner knows noble's family name or estate: "Lord of [Estate], bless you"
- Common formula: "My Lord/Lady, may peace be upon your house"
- Noble may or may not respond verbally - a brief "Hm, carry on" or nod is enough

No Eye Contact or Handshake Unless Invited:

- Keep eyes lowered
- Do NOT presume to shake noble's hand
- Physical contact is avoided - a noble might find it offensive if a peasant reaches out
- Only if noble extends hand (some benevolent lords allow an old retainer to kiss their hand, or a knight might offer hand squeeze to a farmer he knows) can the commoner respond
- Appropriate action: bow and maintain respectful distance
- Example: Farmer brought before Lady Emillea to petition - he would kneel, bow head, speak only when permitted, and not rise until told

Gender Dynamics:

- If noble is a lady and commoner is a man: extra care to be unobtrusive
- Men avoid directly approaching a noblewoman unless ordered, to ensure propriety
- A male commoner encountering a noblewoman might bow and wait for her to acknowledge or pass rather than initiating conversation
- If she needs something (asking for directions): respond with eyes averted and excessive politeness ("Yes, My Lady," "As you wish, My Lady")
- Female commoner dealing with male noble: curtsy deeply and behave with great modesty
- Commoner's gender grants no privilege - noble's status is paramount
- All observe general modesty norms (men not seeming bold toward noble ladies, etc.)

Kneeling in Audience:

- In any semi-formal meeting (village meeting with lord present, commoner before magistrate or prince): commoners kneel on one knee as default posture when addressing nobility
- May remain kneeling for duration of conversation unless told to rise
- During tax collection: villagers line up and kneel one by one as official approaches; stay low until official moves on
- A commoner who rose without permission or failed to show proper submission could be scolded or punished for insolence

Leaving the Noble's Presence:

- Ask permission to withdraw when business is done
- Say: "With your leave, My Lord, I shall depart" with a fresh bow
- Turning one's back to a noble directly is rude

- Back away a few steps while still bowed before straightening and going on their way

C. NOBLES INTERACTING SOCIALLY WITH NOBLES (Informal Contexts)

When nobles meet outside formal settings (private dinner, hunt, chance encounter in town), they relax some stiff court rules, but hierarchy and courtesy still govern their greetings.

Between Friends/Equals:

- May greet almost like commoners do, but with aristocratic grace
- A handshake accompanied by direct eye contact can signal mutual respect among noblemen
- Noble friends might hug lightly or pat each other on the back, especially after long absence
- Two dukes who are cousins might embrace upon meeting at a country estate
- Women nobles who are close might exchange cheek kisses or embrace
- These displays are typically done in private or informal gatherings
- In public: maintain decorum with warm smile, pronounced but not exaggerated bow, words of pleasure ("It is wonderful to see you again!")

Rank Awareness:

- If there's a rank difference (Marquis meeting Baron): even informally the Baron uses higher title and possibly bows
- The atmosphere might be friendly, but implicit hierarchy is acknowledged
- Higher-ranking noble may quickly say "Oh, no need for that formality today" and clap the other on the shoulder
- But the gesture of respect would have been offered at least initially
- Nobles are very conscious of precedence

- A proud higher noble expects deference even at casual supper; more progressive/kindly nobles might downplay rank in private
- Both parties signal statuses through small cues: junior might start to rise when senior enters room; senior might motion for them to sit again

Titles and Names:

- Often still address each other by title, but can be more relaxed with names if family or friends
- An older duke might permit a younger count to call him "Uncle Horan" if related, instead of "Your Grace"
- Among peers who are close: first names or affectionate nicknames might be used in private
- Two sisters who are a duchess and countess call each other by given name in personal moments
- If a servant or outsider is present: nobles revert to using titles with each other, keeping up appearances
- A nuanced dance of familiarity vs. formality

Gender Etiquette:

- Chivalry is more evident in informal settings
- A noble gentleman stands when a lady (especially of equal or higher rank) enters the room as a sign of respect
- He may bow over a lady's hand in greeting (lightly touching lips to back of her hand) in a genteel way
- This hand-kiss gesture is common in daily social calls among nobility
- Noble ladies perform elegant curtseys to one another when visiting (shallower than court curtseys - more of a polite dip)
- If the lady is much younger or clearly lower standing: an older/higher-ranked lady might simply nod and smile rather than curtsey in return

- Noble men NEVER presume to hug or kiss a noble lady (other than perhaps a relative) in public
- A bow and verbal greeting is standard unless the lady initiates more intimate gesture

Household Settings:

- Servants greet noble masters at start of each day with specific protocols ("Good morning, My Lord" with bow)
- Nobles might greet each other at breakfast with light pleasantries
- A noble parent might expect children to give a morning bow or kiss on the hand
- These in-family greetings reinforce hierarchy even at home
- Children of nobles show respect to parents or elder siblings much like commoner children do, but more polished
- Example: A 10 -year-old Lordling bows to his mother the Duchess each morning; she might then kiss his forehead - a mix of formality and affection

PART III: INFLUENCE OF HIERARCHY, GENDER, AND AGE

HIERARCHY (Social Rank)

- Social rank is the FOREMOST factor
- Lower status individuals always greet higher status individuals FIRST and with more pronounced gestures
- The higher one's rank, the less they need to physically demonstrate deference
- Example: A noble expects commoners to bow first and deeply; the noble may only nod in return
- Two people of unequal rank within the same class (master craftsman vs. apprentice) similarly follow this pattern

- A breach (e.g., peasant slapping a lord on the back casually) would be shocking
- Rank can sometimes outweigh age - a young lord still expects an old peasant to bow low, though the lord might add a courteous "Please rise, elder" out of personal kindness

GENDER

- Gender norms add a layer of courtesy
- Men are expected to be chivalrous and slightly deferential in mixed-gender greetings, especially toward women of their own class
- Women are accorded automatic respect in social interaction
- Saying in Aicruae: "A lady's greeting is a gift; a man should accept it gratefully"
- A man often waits for a woman to extend her hand or acknowledge him before greeting her
- Women expected to uphold grace and modesty
- A noblewoman offers a measured nod or curtsy but not overly low unless greeting someone of much higher rank (like the Queen)
- A man bows slightly deeper to a woman if they are of equal rank, out of courtesy
- Example (two commoners meeting): Man dips his head and says "Good day, Mistress"; woman might simply smile or nod
- Among nobles: Gentleman says "Good evening, Lady Alina" with bow; she replies "Good evening" with slighter curtsy
- Gender segregation in certain contexts: men generally don't kiss or hug women in public greetings unless family
- Women friends might embrace or kiss cheeks in private
- These gendered nuances stem from both courtesy and notions of propriety

AGE

- Age commands respect in Aicruae's culture

- Younger people are taught to greet elders with deference regardless of class
- This means: standing when older person enters, using honorifics ("Sir," "Madam," or familial titles like "Auntie"), employing respectful gestures (bows, hand-kisses for elders)
- An older person of the same class is often greeted FIRST by the younger
- Example: If a 20-year-old and 50-year-old merchant meet, the younger initiates "Good day, Master" with head-bow; elder responds kindly
- Age sometimes overrides minor differences in status: a young minor noble might show extra politeness to a very elderly commoner, addressing them as "Elder"
- However, if age difference is small and one party has clearly higher rank, rank wins out
- Example: 30 -year-old noble vs. 60 -year-old commoner - the commoner must bow first deeply, though the noble might show mild extra respect in wording
- Within families: children and youths not only bow to elders but often perform morning and nightly greetings as signs of filial piety
- Elders often bless younger people during greetings (grandfather might place hand on grandchild's head and invoke blessing of Razar's light)

COMBINED FACTORS

In many greetings, these factors overlap.

Example scenario: A young male commoner and an older noblewoman cross paths.

- Hierarchy says: commoner must show deference
- Gender says: man should be very careful and let the lady lead
- Age says: youth should respect the elder
- Result: Young man immediately steps aside, bows exceedingly low, remains silent unless older noblewoman chooses to speak or gesture to him
- Only then might he say a polite greeting or answer any query she has

- If she passes without a word, he stays bowed until she's gone

Typical Day (Common People):

Western Aicruae Farmer (The Aoner region)

1. Dawn (First Light of Razar): Wake before sunrise; the day begins with a brief prayer facing east, touching forehead then chest (heart toward Razar). Simple breakfast: leftover grain porridge, perhaps with berries or a boiled egg (eggs are plentiful here). Children assigned morning chores: feeding chickens, collecting eggs, drawing water from the well.
2. Morning: Field work begins at first full light; planting, weeding, or harvesting depending on season. The "sun never leaves the sky" in Western Aicruae, so workers wear the head covering constantly. Mid-morning break for water and dried fruit; work continues until the sun is directly overhead.
3. Midday (High Sun): Mandatory rest during the hottest hours; this is both practical and religious (Razar's gaze is too strong for mortal work). Main meal of the day: bread, cheese, vegetables, possibly fish if near a river. Napping in shade; children might play games.
4. Afternoon: Return to fields. Women who aren't field-working handle textile tasks: spinning, mending, preserving food. Children old enough to work (around 8-10) help with lighter tasks: carrying water, chasing birds from crops.
5. Evening: Work ends at sunset; another brief prayer of thanks. An evening meal is lighter: soup, bread, whatever's left. Families gather early to bed; candles are expensive.

Key detail: Death is common in Western Aicruae from heat exhaustion and overwork. Families might lose 1-2 members per generation to "sun sickness." This over the years has created a fatalistic but tight-knit community culture.

Northern Aicruae Fisherman (Aishae/Paler)

1. Pre-Dawn: Fishermen rise in darkness to catch the morning tides. Quick meal of cold salted fish and bread; a sip of weak ale. Prayer to Zopha (Sea Goddess) as well as Razar; coastal people honor both.

2. Morning: Out on boats by first light. Work in crews of 5-8, often family groups. The smell of fish permeates everything: clothes, skin, homes. Humid climate means constant dampness; workers wear shorter tunics and roll trousers to the knee.
3. Midday: Return to shore with catch. Fish are immediately sorted: some for local sale, some for salting/smoking (preservation). Women and children handle shore work: gutting, salting, hanging fish to dry. Lunch is often eaten standing; fresh fish grilled over driftwood fires.
4. Afternoon: Mending nets (critical; a torn net means lost income). Trading at the harbor: selling catch to merchants, buying supplies. Boat maintenance; checking hulls for damage.
5. Evening: Northern Aicruae is best described as having a "humid but favorable" climate, so evenings are pleasant. Stronger community gathering culture than farming villages; fishermen depend on each other for survival at sea. Shell jewelry and flower garlands are common; festivals are more frequent here.

Key detail: Northern Aicruaens are notably wealthier than other commoners; "usually rich and enjoy a flourishing and abundant lifestyle." This means slightly better food, more festival days, and less grinding poverty.

MAGIC

Relationship to Magic:

Magic Users (%):

Magic Institutions:

Regulations:

FOREIGN RELATIONS

Allies:

Enemies:

Trade Partners:

Historical Conflicts:

HISTORY TIMELINE

[Date]: [Event]

[Date]: [Event]

(Continue as needed)

Transformation Throughout History:

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

Significance in Book 1:

Significance in Book 2:

Significance in Book 3:

Significance in Book 4:

Key Scenes Set Here:

NOTES

Aicruae was a country where people believed that the gods chose the king, Divine right used to justify brutal politics and silence opposition. Where threats to the official faith result in purges, exile, etc. A place where trials were used as theater, verdicts were decided in advance; the trial was about optics, not justice. And where repentance used to frame the state as merciful, even while killing the accused. A place where executions were very public and used as warnings, Heads displayed, titles stripped, bloodlines erased. Imprisoned nobility prison was often a political holding cell, not a punishment but they were not exempt from punishment either in cases of crimes like treason. A place where clothing marked rank, wearing the wrong color or fabric was a crime. Pageants * Touranments were usually politics disguised as entertainment. A place where history was written by the victors, History was propaganda; today's traitor is tomorrow's villainized footnote.

In Aicruae, a queen's worth was often tied to producing male heirs, making every pregnancy a national affair. Behind the scenes, mothers, wives, and widows manipulated marriages and alliances, while disposable consorts were cast aside, annulled, or accused once their usefulness ended.

Ladies-in-waiting served as informants, turning women's spaces into surveillance hubs and rumor mills. Dowager queens could be too powerful to ignore yet too dangerous to trust. Nobles competed fiercely for influence, with retainers displaying livery colors as

feudal loyalty outweighed national unity. On the battlefield, legitimacy was decided, victory seen as God's favor, while a single loss could erase a ruler's right to reign. The crown could change hands multiple times in a generation, with kings promising mercy only to execute rivals "for the good of the realm." Servants and attendants often funneled secrets to opposing factions. Dangerous advisors who heard the monarch's private thoughts could become terrifyingly influential. Falls from grace were common, disgrace, loss of titles, imprisonment in a tower, or execution often served political convenience. Compliments could hide veiled insults, and survival at court depended on reading tone perfectly. A courtier might rise spectacularly through royal affection, only to fall just as quickly when enemies struck. Boy-kings under the control of regents or ambitious relatives created perfect conditions for coups and "protective" imprisonments. Queens and noblewomen were used to unite claims, calm rebellions, or legitimize rule, often reluctantly. In a realm where a ruler's claim to the throne could be shaky, due to female lineage, rumors of illegitimacy, or foreign blood, there was always the looming threat of a "truer" heir.

= NORTHERN AICRUAEE [Type: Region/Island Province]

BASIC INFORMATION Name: Northern Aicruae Also Known As: The Northern Isles
Type:

Regional Province (Island) Nation: Aicruae Region: Northern Aicruae Population:
20 Million People

GEOGRAPHY & LAYOUT Physical Setting: Located on a smaller island off the coast of Aicruae, geographically separate from the mainland but still considered part of Aicruae. Close enough to the mainland to maintain strong ties. Climate: Humid but favorable for the most part, as long as the smell of fish is not something that bothers you. Layout/Structure: Port region used primarily for fishing and exportation. Notable Districts/Areas: The Town of Aishae, The Town of Paler, Port Vento

GOVERNANCE Who Rules Here:

- The Town of Aishae: House Arvento
- The Town of Paler: House Mena
- Port Vento: House Dajanyi

ECONOMY & FUNCTION Primary Purpose: Fishing and exportation Industries: Fishing, maritime trade, shipbuilding What It's Famous For: Aishae is considered the safest place for women and children in all of Aicruae because of the Infant Laws and Arvento Night Soldiers.

CULTURE & CHARACTER Atmosphere: Flourishing and abundant Local Customs: Citizens are usually wealthy and enjoy a prosperous lifestyle.

DEMOGRAPHICS Who Lives Here: Wealthy merchants, fishermen, traders Social Classes Present: Primarily wealthy citizens

REGIONAL DISTINCTIONS

Overview: Geography deeply shapes subcultures across Aicruae.

Coastal & Lowland Regions (including capital and major ports):

- More cosmopolitan
- Frequent foreign contact
- Somewhat more fluid social customs
- Commoners in port towns may rise by commerce

Highland & Northern Regions:

- Rugged and isolated
- Mountain clans emphasize martial traditions, horsemanship, and loyalty to local warlords (often minor nobles)
- Adhere strictly to ancestral customs
- More conservative in dress and ritual (e.g., wearing furs in winter)
- Function almost as a separate province
- String of fishing communities governed by local lords (House Arvento, etc.)
- Islanders speak a distinct dialect
- Practice additional sea-spirit rites alongside the Circle's worship

ECONOMY (Additional Details)

Currency Note: The Rern was stable and widely recognized; one Rern roughly valued at 20 USD equivalent, indicating substantial purchasing power

Additional Industries:

- Whaling: Smaller niche industry in the far Quather Sea, providing whale oil for lamps
- Metalworking: Small-scale; blacksmiths crafted farming tools, weapons for the royal army, and the coveted Aicruan steel plowshare (which improved agricultural yields)
- Timber: Oak, beech, and pine harvested and shipped to nations with fewer woodlands

Major City Populations:

- Lajazer (capital): 5 million inhabitants; one of the richest and most modern cities
- Rewqo: 10 million people; extended trade town feeding into Lajazer's economy

Trade Hub Oversight:

- Port Vento: Safeguarded by House Dajanyi
- Hadiber: Granary town under House Kulio's protection
- Melert: Famed for fruit markets, overseen by House Hige

EASTERN AICRUAE [Type: Region]

BASIC INFORMATION Name: Eastern Aicruae Type: Regional Province Nation: Aicruae Region: Eastern Aicruae Population: 40,000 people

GEOGRAPHY & LAYOUT Physical Setting: Borders the country of Pireaynea
Climate: Colder than any other part of Aicruae; citizens wear heavier layers of clothing. Layout/Structure: Primarily military-based but also handles production of goods and clothes. All citizens reside in one town: Haleker. Notable Districts/Areas: The Town of Haleker

GOVERNANCE Who Rules Here:

- House Vika (one end of the city)

- House Aedria (opposite end of the city)

ECONOMY & FUNCTION Primary Purpose: Military operations, production of goods and clothing Industries: Textile production, manufacturing, military What It's Famous For: Has the largest unhoused and poor population in Aicruae. More than half its population makes less than 5,000 Rern.

Trade Significance: Supposed to generate large amounts of money, but citizens are heavily taxed by House Vika.

CULTURE & CHARACTER Atmosphere: Crime is extremely common; crimes committed are brutal, but punishments inflicted by House Vika and House Aedria are even more brutish. Local Customs: Heavy taxation, brutal justice system Religious Sites: None noted

DEMOGRAPHICS Who Lives Here: Military personnel, textile workers, the poor and unhoused Social Classes Present: Predominantly impoverished

NOTES Citizens must also worry about conflicts that might arise with Pireaynea, the country they practically border, which has had a difficult relationship with Aicruae.

=WESTERN AICRUAE [Type: Region]

BASIC INFORMATION Name: Western Aicruae Type: Regional Province Nation: Aicruae

Region: Western Aicruae Population: 65 Million People (within three large towns)

GEOGRAPHY & LAYOUT Physical Setting: More grass and lake than is needed. Fruit can be found in every tree. Climate: Warmer than Eastern Aicruae; the sun never seems to leave the sky.

Layout/Structure: Agricultural heartland organized into three large towns Notable Districts/Areas:

The Town of Hadiber, The Town of Melert, The Aoner

GOVERNANCE Who Rules Here:

- The Town of Hadiber: House Kulio
- The Town of Melert: House Hige
- The Aoner: House Najil

ECONOMY & FUNCTION Primary Purpose: Food production, supplies, farms, and mills Industries: Agriculture, food processing What It's Famous For: Maintaining the kingdom's food needs

CULTURE & CHARACTER Atmosphere: Productive but harsh Local Customs: Extensive agricultural labor

DEMOGRAPHICS Who Lives Here: Farmers, agricultural workers Social Classes Present: Working class

NOTES Death is very common here because of harsh heat conditions and the extensive amount of work needed to farm and maintain the kingdom's food needs.

SOUTHERN AICRUAЕ

=&SOUTHERN AICRUAЕ [Type: Region]

BASIC INFORMATION Name: Southern Aicruae Type: Regional Province Nation: Aicruae Region: Southern Aicruae Population: 2 million people (aside from prisoners)

GEOGRAPHY & LAYOUT Physical Setting: A barren wasteland with nothing to offer Climate: Arid and inhospitable Layout/Structure: Prison territory with scattered settlements Notable Districts/Areas: Basar Tari

GOVERNANCE Who Rules Here:

- House Yuera
- House Vemer

ECONOMY & FUNCTION Primary Purpose: Location of the largest prison in all of Aicruae Industries: Prison administration, illegal business What It's Famous For: Suspected ties with the Underground Illegal Business (UIB); attracts people looking to make quick money

CULTURE & CHARACTER Atmosphere: Crime runs more rampant here than anywhere else in Aicruae Local Customs: Many people have been leaving Southern Aicruae and moving to Western Aicruae to seek a more "stable" life with jobs and a slightly longer lifespan.

DEMOGRAPHICS Who Lives Here: Prisoners, criminals, those seeking quick money Social Classes Present: Predominantly impoverished and criminal elements

REWQO

Region: Capital Region (just outside Lajazer)

Population: 10 Million

Type: City

Description: The city just outside the capital Lajazer.

Rewqo serves as a satellite city to the capital and, during the Aicruan Civil War, became the site of one of the war's most significant battles.

War Significance - Battle of Rewqo (7,218 BR):

The Battle of Rewqo took place during Civil War Year Four and resulted in the death of Princess Iris Aleka Patton.

After being deserted by her knights, Iris fought alone, was captured alive by Solis, broke free, killed 15 men, and was ultimately killed by Solis himself. Solis buried both Iris and later Orcus beneath a temple of Nellebrie at Rewqo.

Chapter Reference: Ch. 43-53 (Year Four)

Cross-references:

- IRIS ALEKA PATTON (In Story Characters)
- LAJAZER (Locations - existing entry)

JASEREIEY

Region: [TBD - likely Eastern or Central Aicruae]

Population: 15 Million

Type: Town

Noble House: House Leva

Description: A large town that serves as the seat of House Leva. Jasereiey is notable for its mineral mines, which became strategically contested during the civil war.

War Significance - Battle of Jasereiey / Trench Warfare (7,221 BR):

During Civil War Year One, Jasereiey was the site of trench warfare as both sides fought over control of the mineral mines. The terrain around the mines favored fortified positions, making it one of the few locations where sustained trench warfare was strategically logical.

Chapter Reference: Ch. 10-21 (Year One)

Cross-references:

- HOUSE LEVA (Noble Houses - if entry exists)

BARETA

Region: [TBD - one of Orcus's three strongholds]

Type: Stronghold / Fortified City

Description: One of Orcus's three main strongholds during the civil war (alongside Nyeo and Valea).

War Significance - Massacre at Bareta (7,220 BR):

During Civil War Year Two, Orcus attacked Bareta (which had fallen to Solis) and killed over 200 women and children, enslaving the men. Mihel Kulio was given command of Solis's second army to recover Bareta, but Iris won the battle and Mihel lost his left eye.

Chapter Reference: Ch. 22-23 (Year Two)

Cross-references:

- ORCUS EMERE PATTON (In Story Characters)
- MIHEL KULIO (In Story Characters)
- NYEO, VALEA (Locations)

NYEO

Region: [TBD — one of Orcus's three strongholds]

Type: Stronghold / Fortified City

Description: The second of Orcus's three strongholds.

War Significance (7,220-7,219 BR):

During Year Two, Mihel accidentally revealed plans to attack Nyeo to Harnua, who informed Orcus. The resulting counterattack cost Mihel his leg. This betrayal - Harnua choosing Orcus over her own brother - marks the point where Harnua's loyalty shifts irrevocably.

Chapter Reference: Ch. 28 (Year Two)

Cross-references:

- HARNUA KULIO (In Story Characters)
- MIHEL KULIO (In Story Characters)

VALEA

Region: [TBD — one of Orcus's three strongholds]

Type: Stronghold / Fortified City

Description: Orcus's third most powerful stronghold and a major strategic position during the civil war.

War Significance:

- Year Two (7,220 BR): Solis attacks and captures Valea, killing 800 of Orcus's men while sparing women and children. Solis and Esterica marry in Valea - their wedding invitation to Orcus is sent as a deliberate provocation. The people of Valea give Solis his first nickname: "the Golden King."
- Year Five (7,217 BR): Grand Sorcerer Sevtor of House

Orana attacks Valea using magic, killing 15,000 people.

This is the most devastating single attack of the war and demonstrates the destructive potential of organized magic used as a weapon of war. The attack terrifies Solis,

Esterica, Maen, and Mihel, and triggers Solis's investigation into magic users' weaknesses.

Chapter References: Ch. 24-25 (Year Two), Ch. 55 (Year Five)

Cross-references:

- GRAND SORCERER SEVTOR (In Story Characters)
- HOUSE ORANA (Noble Houses)
- MAGIC SYSTEM - Sevtor's Attack (Magic System hub doc)

THE BLUE TOWER

–

- A prison for nobility within Aicruae, located near the capital. FOREIGN RELATIONS

Diplomatic Stance: Historically cautious yet engaged, aiming for neutrality while leveraging cultural ties. Reputation for "perfectly neutral" official stance in international matters. Sometimes viewed as a "loose cannon" due to internal power struggles affecting foreign policy unpredictably.

GHERCI - Allied by Faith and Tradition

Relationship: Closest of all neighbors; deep religious and cultural links

Shared Values: Both follow Circle of Eternal Light; Gherci's devout society resonates with Aicruae's piety

History: Historic alliances and royal intermarriage forged bonds of friendship

Trade: Extensive exchange (Aicruae supplies food and fish; Gherci supplies temple wares, cloth, pilgrims/tourists)

Strategic Cooperation: Both work to contain Pireaynea's chaos; open borders for pilgrims; informal defensive understanding

Tensions: Gherci's immense size and theocratic rigidity sometimes leads to condescension toward smaller Aicruae

Summary: Staunch allies aligned by religion and mutual trade

PIREAYNEA - Uneasy Neighbors

Relationship: Thorny, characterized by distrust and occasional conflict

View of Pireaynea: Seen as lawless, "sketchy" country filled with bandits

Border Issues: Porous and troubled; bandit raids and smuggling common

Trade: Minimal and unofficial despite Pireaynea's crop abundance; Aicruaean merchants deal through Ghercian intermediaries

Religious Divide: Pireaynea worships only Allan (monotheism), which Aicruae's clergy considers heresy against the Pantheon

Conflicts: Minor border wars sparked by Aicruan attempts to root out bandits or Pireaynean retaliation

Strategy: Fortify eastern towns (like Haleker); occasionally support Pireaynean warlords who promise stability

Summary: Guarded neutrality; no open conquest but no trust either

COELUM - Distant Sympathy

Relationship: Neutral pity; minimal direct interaction

Location: North of Gherci; does not border Aicruae directly

Known As: "The Forsaken Place" - ravaged by misrule, famine, and debt

Economy: Currency (Opeali) holds "little to no trading value" abroad; trade via barter or third-party mediation

Religion: Mostly atheist (people feel abandoned by gods); Aicruae views this as sad but not threatening

Humanitarian Aid: Aicruae occasionally shipped grain during famines at subsidized prices

Summary: Formally neutral with compassionate concern; no significant commitments

EQUATEIY - Cautious Rivalry

Relationship: Correct but cool; tense beneath formalities

Equateiy's Reputation: Wealthiest country in the world; famed for banking houses and jewel mines

Trade: Aicruae exports foodstuffs and raw materials; imports luxury goods (gems, crafted tools, financial loans)

Ideological Conflict: Equateiy is cosmopolitan and wealth-driven; Aicruae shares Gherci's traditional, pious values

Political Meddling: Equateiy occasionally funded dissident Aicruae nobles or rival claimants to influence balance of power

Summary: Guarded neutrality; outwardly friendly, privately full of wariness and subtle competition

VIKITSV - Neutral Trade and Academic Ties

Relationship: Generally neutral with positive tilt in commerce

Geography: No land border (Gherci lies between); faces Aicruae across Fetora Sea to southeast

Climate: Known as coldest country in world atop Mount Aicren

Trade: Aicruae supplies grain, fish, produce; Vikitsv supplies fine craftsmanship (astrolabes, clockwork mechanisms, superior steel weapons)

Academic Exchange: Tradition of Aicruae nobility sending bright young minds to study in Vikitsv's academies

Political Distance: Vikitsv's secular, scholarly orientation contrasts with Gherci's theocratic ways;

Aicruae must tread carefully to not offend Gherci

Summary: Pragmatic neutrality; trade and knowledge exchange without formal alliances

Political Fractions

Divine Fraction

Wants the monarchy and the nobility class system. Believe that it was their Divine right to be born nobles. This includes House Patton, House Vika, House Vemer, House Kulio, House Najil, House Hige, and some other noble houses.

Neutral Fraction

Each of these Houses share values of both sides. This includes House Arvento, House Mena, House Caraen, House Aedria and some other noble houses.

Common People Fraction

Hates the monarchy and the class system overall. This includes House Leva, House Yurea, House Dajanyi and some other noble houses.

GHERCI

Gherci "[The Land of Eternal Silence]"

BASIC INFORMATION

Official Name: Gherci

Dates: Common Names: The Land of Eternal Silence Flag: The flag is encircled by a border of small blue diamond-shaped gems that shimmer like sapphires, while the field itself features flowing ribbon-like sections of deep blue and golden-yellow that curve gracefully across the composition, with a canton in the upper left containing white and blue triangular sections, and adorned with golden sun symbols—a simple pointed star and a more elaborate sun with flowing rays—along with decorative tassels that suggest religious banners or temple ornaments. The blue diamonds represent both the enormous wealth generated by temple donations and the nation's position as possessor of the third most valued currency (Miuae at twenty-six dollars), while also evoking the precious, gem-like quality of religious devotion and the tourism industry built around Gherci's countless temples. The golden sun symbols clearly reference Vapaz, the god of the sky and king of the gods, whom Gherci favors above all others despite worshipping the entire pantheon, with the sun's radiance representing divine authority and the belief that kings are messengers of the gods whose word must guide the people. The flowing golden ribbons against the blue background suggest both the elegant, modest fashion favored by Gherci's nobles—who dress in monotone blacks and whites—and the graceful movement of religious processions and ceremonies, while blue traditionally represents devotion, heaven, and the eternal silence for which the land is named. The banner-like quality of the design reflects the nation's unique power structure where House Mava may be the royal family, but true authority rests with the Teire—the temple hierarchy led by the Main Master—symbolizing how temporal and spiritual power flow together like interwoven ribbons throughout this ancient nation founded by Saint Duri in 8,763 BR. The prominence of fabric-like elements also acknowledges the severe gender disparity (78% female, 22% male) that has caused the once-enormous

population of 389 million to decline at 0.9% annually for fifty years, as the flowing, feminine qualities of the design honor the predominantly female population while the masculine sun symbols represent the divine masculine authority of Vapaz and the rare male leadership.

Basic Information: Gherci is the largest and most populous nation on the continent, a devout theocratic monarchy where religion forms the foundation of the state. The kingdom is poetically called "The Land of Eternal Silence" in reference to the calm, reverential atmosphere in its temple groves and misty highlands.

Capital: Tarmet

- Situated near the center of the vast kingdom
- Built along one of the great rivers flowing from the Coelum mountains
- Flat to gently rolling terrain ideal for monumental temples and palaces
- Home to The Teire (the grand central temple) and great bazaar

Founded: [Date TBD] Founder: [TBD] Founding Information: [TBD]

GEOGRAPHY

—Location: Central heart of the continent Borders: West: Aicruae North: Coelum East: Vikitsv

South: Pireaynea

Major Bodies of Water:

- Henem Bay (short coastline on inland sea bay to the north)
- Large river systems flowing from Coelum mountains through the heartland
- Numerous irrigation canals feeding farmland

Terrain Types:

- Central heartland: Fertile plains crisscrossed by large rivers, rolling plains and irrigated gardens
- Evergreen forests: Scattered around temples and along rivers, providing timber and pilgrimage sites

- Eastern/Northern mountains: Majestic mountain ranges forming natural borders (e.g., mountains separating Gherci from Equateiy), often mist-shrouded
- Southern regions: Transition into semi-arid steppes toward Pireaynea or far interior
- Eastern frontier: Sharp ridges and cliffs marking the start of Vikitsv's high mountains

Climate: Warm-temperate with regional variations

- Coastal areas (Henem Bay): Humid and mild, fostering vibrant port cities and gardens
- Inland: Hot, sunlit summers and cool winters with sufficient rainfall to keep plains green and rivers flowing
- Overall: Much of the kingdom is hospitable and arable, explaining how it historically supported the continent's largest population

COASTLINES & ISLANDS

- Northern Coast (Henem Bay):
- Short coastline on an inland sea bay
- Humid and mild climate
- Vibrant port cities and gardens

FORESTS & MOUNTAINS

- Evergreen Forests:
- Grew around temples and along rivers
- Provide timber and tranquil pilgrimage sites

Mountain Ranges:

- Eastern and northern mountains form natural borders
- Mountains separating Gherci from Equateiy are often mist-shrouded, adding to Gherci's mystical aura

- Eastern frontier with Vikitsv features sharp ridges and cliffs providing a historical defensive barrier

FARMLANDS & VALLEYS

- Distribution: The core of Gherci is a fertile plain carefully irrigated to feed its huge population.

Soil Quality: Rich alluvial soil from river systems supports enormous agricultural output, though Gherci still imports additional food from Aicruae to feed its masses.

Key Agricultural Features:

- Rolling plains and gardens throughout the heartland
- Extensive canal irrigation systems
- Feeds the continent's largest population

KEY LOCATIONS

- Capital City: Tarmet

Major Cities/Towns: [TBD]

Strategic Locations:

- Eastern frontier ridges (defensive barrier against Vikitsv)
- Mountain passes to Equateiy

Sacred Sites:

- The Teire (grand central temple in Tarmet)
- Countless temples and holy sites throughout the kingdom
- Tranquil pilgrimage sites in evergreen forests

POPULATION

- Total Population: 389 Million People (the continent's largest population)

Gender Breakdown: 22% Male, 78% Female

- Historical events skewed gender ratio significantly

- Led to unique social rules including ban on polygamy

Ethnic Composition: [Barie]: [%] [Taili]: [%] [Nemeri]: [%] [Guio]: [%]

Population Density: High, particularly in river valleys and around Tarmet

Major Population Centers: Tarmet, various temple cities

GOVERNMENT

Government Type: Theocratic Monarchy

Current Ruler (By Era): Solis's Era: Crandona's Era: Minara's Era:

Power Structure:

1. The Teire / Main Master [The religious institution technically outranks the monarch in matters of faith; the Main Master (high priest) and his inner circle have enormous influence and can dictate certain policies]
2. King/Queen [Officially considered God's messenger on Earth, ruling by divine right and expected to heed the pronouncements of the priesthood. Seen as quasi-sacred.]
3. Princes/Princesses/Heirs [Revered from birth as children of the quasi-sacred monarch]
4. The Teire Inner Circle [Lord Protector of the temple, Supreme Inner Court keeper]
5. High Clergy [High priests, abbots - hold great sway over law and education]
6. Nobles (Dukes, Lords) [Govern provinces but expected to be pious; often fund temples. Come below clergy in esteem.]
7. Commoners [Mostly peasant farmers or craftsmen; live in a society valuing tradition, modesty, and community discipline]

Laws: Strict and based on religious doctrine. Crime rates relatively low, but punishments can be severe under theocratic law.

Noble Houses: [TBD]

Political Factions: [TBD]

ECONOMY

- Currency: Miuae
- Valued at roughly \$26 USD each
- Third most valued currency in the world
- Reflects global trust in Gherci's stable economy

Primary Industries:

- Commerce and trade (central location makes Gherci a hub for overland caravans)
- Religious tourism and pilgrimage
- Agriculture (though still imports food from Aicruae)
- Temple donations (significant revenue stream)
- Modest-fashion textiles
- Religious crafts (manuscripts, stone carvings, jewelry for temple use)

Major Exports:

- Religious icons and temple wares
- Modest yet elegant clothing (renowned among pious communities)
- Temple spices
- Religious manuscripts and crafts

Major Imports:

- Food from Aicruae (grain, fish) to feed massive population

Wealth Distribution: [TBD]

Trade Hub: Tarmet's great bazaar serves as a continental trade hub where goods from Aicruae (food, raw materials) and Equateiy/Vikitsv (luxuries, gems) exchange hands.

Pilgrimage Economy:

- Countless temples and holy sites attract pilgrims from all over the continent

- Pilgrims donate generously, making temple donations a significant revenue stream
- Entire industry of pilgrimage hospitality: inns, markets, guides
- Artisans produce pilgrim souvenirs and goods bought by nobles for piety

MILITARY

- Military Strength: [TBD - implied to be significant given size]

Army Composition: [TBD]

Notable Military Traditions: [TBD]

Strategic Advantages:

- Enormous population base for recruitment
- Mountain ranges on eastern frontier provide natural defense
- Central location allows projection of power in multiple directions

Weaknesses: [TBD]

RELIGION

- Primary Religion: Circle of Eternal Light (zealously worships all gods of the Pantheon)

God(s) Worshipped: All twelve gods of the Pantheon

Religious Institutions:

- The Teire: Temple administration that owns Gherci's grand central temple
- Led by Main Master (high priest) who oversees religious law
- Inner circle includes Lord Protector of the temple and Supreme Inner Court keeper
- Technically outranks the king in matters of faith

Clergy Structure:

1. Main Master (highest religious authority)

2. Lord Protector of the temple
3. Supreme Inner Court keeper
4. High priests and abbots
5. Temple priests and scribes

6. Nuns and religious servants

Religious Philosophy: The judgment of the gods is final in all things. The King/Queen is God's messenger on Earth.

CULTURE

- Defining Values: Tradition, modesty, community discipline, piety, humility, purity

Education: Largely religious. Many children (especially girls, given the demographics) are taught to read scripture and may become nuns or scribes. Libraries and scholars attract visitors.

Social Customs:

- Polygamy is banned (one spouse only) to prevent wealthy noblewomen from hoarding husbands given the 78% female population
- Women play prominent roles as landowners, merchants, and even temple officials to fill gaps in the labor force
- High value placed on modesty and temperance

Gender Roles:

- Due to 78% female population, women fill many roles traditionally held by men
- Women serve as landowners, merchants, temple officials
- Polygamy banned to ensure fair distribution of marriage opportunities

Fashion:

- Famously modest and monochromatic
- People favor simple black and white garments

- Highly conservative in style
- Reflects Ghercian virtues of humility and purity
- Higher nobles across countries buy Gherci's high-quality but simple garments

Entertainment: [TBD]

Food & Cuisine: [TBD]

Cultural Reputation: Ghercians often view themselves as guardians of true faith and tradition on the continent, which others sometimes perceive as haughtiness.

MAGIC

—Relationship to Magic: [TBD] Magic Users (%): [TBD] Magic Institutions: [TBD] Regulations: [TBD]

FOREIGN RELATIONS

—AICRUAE — Allied by Faith and Tradition Relationship: Closest of all neighbors; affectionate alliance tempered by occasional frustration Shared Values: Both follow Circle of Eternal Light; sees

Aicruae as spiritual cousin History: Friendly ties with family and marriage links between royal families; cooperated in religious matters (jointly sponsoring Temple at the Cidet) Trade: Appreciates Aicruae's material contributions (Aicruae feeds Gherci's cities with grain and fish, hosts Ghercian pilgrims); Gherci shares scholarly monks and scrolls with Aicruae's libraries Strategic Cooperation: Extended protection in subtle ways; shared intelligence (often about Equateiy's schemes); presented united front culturally Tensions: Often regarded Aicruae's monarchy as too weak to control its nobles; sometimes scolded or diplomatically pressured Aicruae to "get its house in order" The Kamerida Incident: When Aicruae's rogue princess Iris was involved in assassinating Gherci's beloved Princess Kamerida, Gherci's attitude hardened. Feeling betrayed, Gherci swung from neutrality to active alliance with the rightful Aicruaean heir (Solis) against the usurpers, determined to avenge the affront. Summary: Somewhat the senior partner (given size and might) but never sought to conquer Aicruae; viewed Aicruae as necessary counterpart in keeping balance of power against Equateiy and Vikitsv. Any enemy of Aicruae risked becoming an enemy of Gherci.

PIREAYNEA — [TBD]

COELUM — [TBD]

EQUATEIY - [TBD - implied rivalry with their opposing values]

VIKITSV - [TBD]

HISTORY TIMELINE

— [Date]: [Event] [Date]: Princess Kamerida assassinated (involvement of Aicruaeian princess Iris)

(Continue as needed)

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

- Significance in Book 1: Significance in Book 2: Significance in Book 3: Significance in Book 4: Key

Scenes Set Here:

NOTES

- Gherci is a semi-hierocratic state where the Main Master of The Teire technically outranks the king in matters of faith
- The 78% female demographic is a unique element that shaped social customs (polygamy ban, women in prominent roles)
- "Land of Eternal Silence" refers to the serene, reverential atmosphere rather than literal quiet
- Described as the "economic and cultural engine of the continent"
- Gherci and Equateiy are often seen butting heads because their ideals conflict greatly (Gherci's modesty vs. Equateiy's wealth display)

Gherci The Land of Eternal Silence

Gherci was founded by Saint Duri in 8,663 BR and is considered to be one of the most historical countries in the entire world. Unlike most countries, Gherci is mainly controlled by priests and by the temple. There is a royal family which is House Mava but the priests hold much of the country's power.

Population/Demographics

Gherci has a total population of 389 Million People, making it historically the largest population of any country—once so big that other countries' populations could barely be equivalent to it. The country is 78% Female and 22% Male. This drastic gender disparity traces back to the Battle of Relirian (7,402 BR), when Reron's rampage killed men disproportionately-soldiers, village defenders, those who tried to stop him. Gherci, as the largest and most central nation, contributed the most troops to the coalition that fought him, and the slaughter was so total that Gherci lost an entire generation of men. The ratio never fully recovered, and because of this disparity the population has been steadily declining at a rate of 0.9% annually for almost 50 years.

The people of Gherci are 64% of Taili origin (Brown/darker-skinned people with African and South Asian features), 30% of Nemeris origin (Honey-skinned people with Latino features), and 6% other.

Economy

Gherci's economy is based on trading and tourism. People mainly visit Gherci to tour the various temples located all over the country in dedication to the gods. The country also gets significant money from temple donations-visitors donate generously at Gherci's grand temples, making this a major revenue stream. An entire industry of pilgrimage hospitality (inns, markets, guides) thrives here. Many higher nobles from other countries like to buy from Gherci's modest fashion. Centrally located, Gherci acts as a hub for overland caravans, with goods from Aicruae (food, raw materials) and from Equateiy/Vikitsv (luxuries, gems) passing through Gherci's markets.

The currency of Gherci is called Miuae, valued at about 26 dollars each, making it the third most valued currency in the entire world.

Culture

Gherci is a heavily religious country. They believe in the absolute worship of the gods and believe that the judgment of the gods is final. The people of Gherci believe that kings are messengers of the gods and that they are meant to rely on the word of the kings to govern. While Gherci worships all the gods, there is one

god that the people of Gherci tend to favor more: Vapaz, the god of the sky. Since he is the king of the gods, the people of Gherci hold him in higher regard.

The people of Gherci value tradition above all else, and they strongly believe in the merging of different traditions. Their fashion/style inspiration usually stick to monotone colors such as black and white. Modesty is considered a vital aspect of their clothing.

.Some see the population decline as divine punishment for failing to stop Reron sooner; others blame the Teire's marriage restrictions. Relirian is a wound, not just history: towns have memorials, families keep lists of the dead, and the Teire holds annual mourning rites. Some Ghercians resent that Reron was ever called a saint at all-they consider it an insult to their ancestors.

Food and Cuisine

Staples include river fish (smoked or salted), grain porridges, flatbreads baked on temple stones, root vegetables, and legumes. Temple gardens grow herbs considered sacred-meals are lightly seasoned but aromatic.

Religious influence shapes dining: certain foods are reserved for holy days, meat is eaten sparingly (livestock are valuable, and the Teire teaches that excess indulgence clouds the spirit), and fasting before major festivals is common.

Aicruae supplies grain and coastal fish. Gherci's own rivers provide freshwater fish, which commoners eat more often than ocean fish (a luxury).

A typical commoner's meal: grain porridge with river fish, roasted vegetables, herb-infused water or weak ale. Nobles eat similarly but with finer presentation-modest even in abundance.

Wildlife and Livestock

Rivers: Carp, catfish, eels. Waterfowl like herons and ducks.

Plains: Grazing cattle (for milk and labor, rarely slaughtered), sheep (wool for modest clothing), goats. Wild hares, foxes, deer in the evergreen forests.

Mountains (periphery): Mountain goats, hawks, wolves. The mist-veiled peaks host creatures rarely seen-pilgrims speak of white-furred cats that watch from the fog.

Sacred Animals

The Eagle (or equivalent raptor): Associated with Vapaz as sky god. Eagles fly highest, closest to the divine. Eagle symbolism appears on temples and national/religious iconography (not House Mava's personal crest). Killing an eagle is sacrilege; harming one brings divine punishment. Eagles are kept at major temples—fed, protected, studied for omens.

The White Dove: Symbol of peace and the divine. Released at major ceremonies (coronations, festivals, mourning rites). Associated with female piety—women keep doves as religious observance.

The Ox: Less sacred but religiously significant—represents honest labor, fertility, the agricultural bounty that sustains Gherci. Sacrificed (or symbolically offered) at harvest festivals.

Entertainment and Leisure

A deeply religious, modest society doesn't mean joyless:

Temple festivals feature processions with music (likely deep, resonant instruments—drums, horns, deep-pitched strings), communal meals, and theatrical reenactments of saints' lives.

Hierarchy Breakdown

The Teire - The owner of the temple, the main church of Gherci. The Teire is composed of three positions:

The Main Master is the person who outranks the Lord Protector and the Supreme Owner of the Inner Court. Every decision and movement they make must be approved and directed by him. The Main Master speaks directly for the gods, and traditionally this position was restricted to men because Vapaz—king of the gods—is male. However, the current Main Master (appointed around 7240 BR) is female for the first time—a major political event. Several Lord Protectors and Supreme Inner Court holders have been women before this.

Lord Protector to the Main Master is a close aide who protects the assets and property of the Main Master and The Teire overall. This position also commands the temple's military forces.

The Supreme Owner of the Inner Court oversees important events involving worship and the application of religion in Gherci.

Upper Teire is traditionally male-dominated, which creates tension with the 78% female population. Lower clergy is mostly female: temple attendants, scribes, educators, healers-women fill these roles by necessity and do the daily work of the faith.

King/Queen - The highest members of nobility, rulers of the nobility. The Main Master of the Teire is really the only one who fully outranks them, but the other members of The Teire are important figures within an even more powerful group.

Unlike most nobility, the King/Acting ruler is not allowed to have more than one active spouse. This also applies to nobility and commoners. This is due to the gender disparity-the Teire banned polygamy after the Battle of Relirian to prevent wealthy women from hoarding husbands. What began as moral protection of grieving widows became permanent law, and now it's treated as divine mandate rather than emergency policy.

Heirs - Second to the King and Queen of Gherci are the heirs; since they are often born of the king and queen they are also revered. House Mava's heirs traditionally serve as generals or military figureheads.

Extended Members of the Royal Family - The active rulers' sister, cousin, mother (former queen), brother, father, uncles, aunts, etc.

Duke/Duchess

Lower-Level Nobles

High Government Officials

Knights

Peasants

Marriage Customs

Reverse dowry: Because men are scarce, families with marriageable sons receive offers from families with daughters. The daughter's family provides a dowry to secure the match—and given the ratio, this can be substantial. Wealthy families can outbid poorer ones for husbands.

Matchmaking by temple: To prevent exploitation and ensure fairness, The Teire regulates marriages. Priests approve or arrange matches, preventing wealthy families from monopolizing all available men.

Marriage is a privilege, not a right: Most Ghercian women simply never marry. This isn't shameful—it's normal. Sisterhood, female households, and religious life absorb women who don't wed.

Men's social position: Men are pressured to marry and father children—it's almost a civic/religious duty. They are often coddled and protected (men who die young worsen the ratio), but they can also potentially be less powerful than in other societies—they're outnumbered everywhere, including in temples, markets, and courts.

Military Structure

Saint Duri's strategies are still studied, so her influence remains strong.

The military is split:

The Crown commands the standing army—knights, infantry, border patrols. House Mava's heirs traditionally serve as generals or figureheads.

The Teire controls the Temple Guard—elite soldiers who protect holy sites, enforce religious law, and answer only to the Main Master. They're smaller in number but better equipped and fanatically loyal. Temple knights are elite warriors who swear religious vows, protect temples, escort pilgrims, and form the core of any army Gherci raises.

In wartime, secular levies are raised by nobles, but command flows through temple channels—generals require Teire approval.

Tension: The Crown needs Teire support to mobilize the full population. The Main Master can withhold blessing for a war he considers unjust—effectively vetoing military action. This has caused friction historically.

Post-Relirian, Gherci's ability to field large armies is crippled with the 78% female population. They've spent 150 years relying on: diplomacy (alliance with Aicruae), religious soft power (no one wants to attack the holy land), geographic barriers (mountains to the east), and a smaller but professional Temple Guard.

Relationship to Other Countries

Gherci, an ancient nation ruled by a powerful priestly hierarchy and famed for its monumental population, booming trade, and revered temples, maintains dynamic, mutually beneficial relationships with other countries, serving as a major cultural and economic hub while fiercely preserving its unique traditions and divine legitimacy. People from other countries sometimes view them as stuck up and super strict.

Geography/Climate

Gherci is a vast, ancient land marked by diverse landscapes that enhance its mystical reputation as "The Land of Eternal Silence." The heartland is filled with fertile, rolling plains where lush gardens and carefully tended temple grounds flourish. Dotted throughout are dense, evergreen forests and meandering rivers that create tranquil settings for pilgrimage and reflection. In the distance, majestic mountain ranges provide a natural fortress, their peaks often veiled in gentle mists that add to the country's ethereal aura.

Along the coast (Gherci has a short coastline on an inland sea bay to the north, the Henem Bay), a mild, humid climate nurtures vibrant port cities that drive the nation's thriving trade and tourism. Inland regions enjoy warm, sunlit summers and cool, refreshing winters, with occasional rains and soft breezes imbuing the landscape with a serene, timeless quality.

The river systems are a defining feature: one great river flows south through Gherci from the Coelum mountains, branching into canals that irrigate farmland. Around Tarmet and other ancient cities, the land is flat to gently rolling-ideal for building monumental temples and palaces. Along the eastern frontier with Vikitsv, sharp ridges and cliffs rise, marking the start of Vikitsv's high mountains and historically providing a defensive barrier.

Parts of Gherci

Capital City: Tarmet

City: Greater Gherci

Town: Beka (better known as Tanya Beka) - A hospital town created by Saint Duri, the founder of Gherci. It has been around since the founding of the country.

Town: Malin - A town in Gherci created in honor of Saint Malign, Saint Duri's long-time hero.

Town: Mother's Hip

Place: The Outer Walls - The outer walls are the walls that surround Gherci's capital city. The name comes from the idea that the statues lining the capital city act as walls, making the city virtually impenetrable.

Aryanara's Territory (Eastern Gherci)

The eastern heartland of Gherci, characterized by fertile river valleys. This is where Aryanara, the more contemplative of the twin prophets, established her teaching center around 14,300 – 14,200 BR. The site attracted scholars and thinkers drawn to the philosophical aspects of the soul's journey. After Aryanara's death, the territory became a major pilgrimage destination. Incorporated into the Kingdom of Gherci by Saint Duri in 8,763 BR. Protected by House Catern, whose Archduke rank reflects the sacred importance of these lands. Later pilgrimage routes developed through the river valleys connecting to other religious sites in Gherci.

Vekta's Territory (Northern Gherci Highlands)

The northern highlands of Gherci, near the mist-shrouded mountains forming the border with Equateiy. This is where Vekta, the more practical of the twin prophets, established her teaching center around 14,300 – 14,200 BR. The site drew pilgrims seeking purification and protection from spiritual corruption. After Vekta's death, the territory became a major pilgrimage destination. Incorporated into the Kingdom of Gherci by Saint Duri in 8,763 BR. Protected by House Catern. The mountainous terrain and proximity to the Equateiy

border gives this territory a distinct character from Aryanara's more temperate river valleys.

Factions of Gherci;

The Royalists:

This faction is made up of loyalists who support the monarchy and believe in the divine right of kings. They consider the king or queen to be the rightful ruler and believe that their power comes from God. They believe that the monarch should have absolute power and that the people should be obedient to their ruler without question. This Includes House Mava and House Pontia and some other minor houses.

The Reformers

This faction is made up of intellectuals and progressive thinkers who believe in modernizing the country and moving it away from traditional medieval practices. This includes House Iarnailo and some other minor houses.

Populists:

They believe that the monarchy and the nobility are out of touch with the needs and desires of the people and that the government should be more representative of the population as a whole. This includes House Dai, and House Malrancis and some other minor houses.

Believers:

This fraction is made up of religious believers who follow the teachings of the Circle of Eternal Light. They believe that religion should have a prominent role in the governance of the country. This includes House Catern, House Renalagardo and some other minor houses.

[Pireaynea] "[The Demon's Pit]"

BASIC INFORMATION

Dates: Common Names: The Demon's Pit Flag: The flag features a cream-colored background enclosed by a rustic barbed wire border with decorative flourishes at

its corners, immediately establishing the nation's rough, frontier character as "The Demons Pit." At its center lies a burgundy and black quartered square rotated to form a diamond, within which sits a lush purple grape cluster accompanied by a single white leaf, while the surrounding field is adorned with black vine leaves bearing red and black berries or cherries, and a red chalice or goblet shape crowns the composition at top center. The agricultural imagery—grapevines, fruit, and chalice—directly reflects Pireayena's primary economic resource, its abundance of crops, though the lack of official trade infrastructure means this bounty cannot easily reach other nations, much like grapes left unharvested on the vine. The wine-red and purple tones evoke viticulture, appropriately connecting to the country's Italian-inspired fashion and the Pocorki language spoken by its people, while the chalice suggests both agricultural plenty and the religious devotion to Allan, the goddess of the earth, whom the monotheistic Pireayena worship for their land's fertility. The barbed wire border symbolizes the nation's troubled origins—founded by seventeen-year-old Deasn of Gherci who fled his homeland after being charged with treason—and its current reputation as a sketchy country filled with bandits and people lacking intelligence, a land that never quite achieved legitimacy despite its young founder's efforts. The black in the central diamond represents the shadow of treason and criminality that haunts the nation's identity, while the red symbolizes both the bloodshed of its controversial founding and the passionate, earthbound nature of its 67 million inhabitants who work the soil but struggle for recognition or proper commerce.

Basic Information: Pireaynea earned the nickname "The Demon's Pit" not from literal geography but from its reputation for violent crimes and lawlessness within the country. Due to its founder's background, many consider Pireaynea a sketchy country filled with bandits and people lacking intelligence.

Capital: Civer

- Built along one of the major rivers
- Natural gathering point of commerce and authority in an otherwise decentralized land

Founded: 7,200 BR Founder: Deasn of Gherci Founding Information: Pireaynea was founded by Deasn of Gherci, who fled Gherci after being charged with treason. Deasn was only 17 when he founded the country. While many consider him a good

king, his weak nature prevented him from coming up with a long-term way of legitimizing Pireaynea as an actual country.

GEOGRAPHY

—Location: South-central swath of the continent, directly east of Aicruae Borders:

West: Aicruae

North: Gherci East: Wraps around a bit of Gherci South: Short coastline along the Fetora Sea

Major Bodies of Water:

- Fetora Sea (short southern coastline)
- Several rivers flowing down from Gherci's highlands, converging as they head toward the southern sea

Terrain Types:

- Open plains: Pireaynea's defining feature—essentially a large steppe or prairie land
- Mostly treeless except for ribbons of trees lining rivers
- River valleys: Gentle valleys where rivers converge
- Southern coastal region: Drier and warmer, giving way to coastal scrubland and salt marshes near shore
- Flat to lightly rolling terrain throughout

Climate: Temperate to warm, conducive to farming

- Spring and summer: Lengthy and mild with regular rains turning plains verdant
- Autumn: Pleasant and relatively dry
- Winter: Cooler but short with only occasional light snow (more common in north near Gherci, rarely in southern lowlands)
- Winds can sweep unchecked across the flatlands, sometimes causing dust storms in drier seasons
- Rivers moderate the climate, keeping soils fertile

Landscape Character: "Seemingly endless fields under an open sky" - one can travel for days through wheat fields or pasture without encountering a major forest or mountain. The geography offers few hiding places or natural boundaries, which paradoxically allows trouble to move freely.

COASTLINES & ISLANDS

- Southern Coast (Fetora Sea):
- Short coastline
- Somewhat Mediterranean feel: hot summers, mild winters
- Coastal plains that can verge on semi-arid further east
- Small fishing villages and one not-so-busy port

FORESTS & MOUNTAINS

- Forests:
- Minimal forest coverage
- Trees primarily limited to ribbons along rivers (willows and poplars by the banks)
- Clusters of settlements form around these riverside greenery pockets

Mountains:

- None within Pireaynea's borders
- Lacks major mountains or natural fortifications
- Contributed to historical vulnerability to incursion

FARMLANDS & VALLEYS

- Distribution: Pireaynea sits in a broad, flat basin-the majority of the country is arable plains and river valleys.

Soil Quality: Fertile land with abundance of crops, primarily grains (wheat, barley) and staple vegetables. Produces large surpluses of wheat, corn, and other foodstuffs.

Agricultural Potential: Potentially the “agricultural heartland” of the region given its vast arable plains, yet due to political instability, never fully capitalized on this potential.

Problems:

- Some areas (especially toward eastern edge) show signs of over-farming and neglect
- Patches of infertile or eroded land (beginnings of a dusty, semi-dry zone)
- Problem exacerbated by country’s lack of strong governance

KEY LOCATIONS

- Capital City: Civer

Major Cities/Towns: [TBD]

Strategic Locations:

- River convergence points
- Border regions with Aicruae (porous and troubled)

Sacred Sites: [TBD - likely temples to Allan]

POPULATION

- Total Population: 67 Million People

Gender Breakdown: Not determined (no official registry has ever been produced for its citizens)

Ethnic Composition: [Barie]: 100% (people of Pireaynea are of Barie origin)

Population Density: Scattered across open plains

Major Population Centers: Civer

GOVERNMENT

Government Type: Weak Monarchy / Decentralized

Current Ruler (By Era): Solis’s Era: Crandona’s Era: Minara’s Era:

Power Structure:

- Central authority is weak
- Local warlords and bandit leaders hold de facto power in many regions
- No well-organized administrative system
- Decentralized governance with little crown oversight in outlying areas

Laws:

- Weak at enforcing tariffs or managing trade agreements
- Crime rates extremely high
- Violent crimes common with inadequate response

Noble Houses: [TBD]

Political Factions: [TBD]

ECONOMY

- Currency: Brezeryiol
- Valued at roughly \$17 USD each
- Not widely circulated internationally due to limited formal trade

Primary Industries:

- Agriculture (grains: wheat, barley, corn; staple vegetables)
- Herding (cattle and sheep grazing on open range)
- Banditry and mercenary work (economy of plunder)

Major Exports:

- Theoretically large surpluses of grain and foodstuffs
- In practice, much produce consumed locally, wasted, or siphoned by smugglers

Major Imports: [TBD - limited due to weak trade networks]

Wealth Distribution: Extremely poor; the country remained cash-poor and underdeveloped despite its agricultural potential.

Economic Problems:

- Historically had no well-organized trade network to export goods
- Central authority too weak to enforce tariffs or manage trade agreements
- Much produce leaves via black markets or under-the-table deals with Gherci and Aicruae merchants
- Few stable industries, leading many desperate Pireayneans to banditry or mercenary work
- Lawless reputation means caravans avoid the country, further stunting regular commerce

MILITARY

- Military Strength: Weak centralized military; strength lies in decentralized warbands

Army Composition:

- No strong central army
- Various warlords command their own forces
- Many Pireayneans work as mercenaries in foreign wars

Notable Military Traditions: Mercenary culture; many hire themselves out to other countries

Strategic Advantages:

- Large population of desperate fighters available as mercenaries
- Open terrain allows rapid movement

Weaknesses:

- No natural fortifications or defensive terrain
- Decentralized command structure
- Lack of formal military organization

RELIGION

- Primary Religion: Monotheistic worship of Allan only

God(s) Worshipped: Allan (exclusively)

Religious Institutions: [TBD]

Clergy Structure: [TBD]

Religious Tensions:

- Pireaynea's monotheistic worship of only Allan is considered heresy by Aicruae's clergy, who follow the full Pantheon of the Circle of Eternal Light
- This religious divide contributes to poor relations with neighbors

CULTURE

- Defining Values: Survival, self-reliance (by necessity rather than choice)

Education: Minimal; reputation suggests "people lacking intelligence" though this may be prejudicial

Social Customs: [TBD]

Gender Roles: [TBD - no census data available]

Fashion: [TBD]

Entertainment: [TBD]

Food & Cuisine: [TBD - presumably grain-based given agricultural output]

Cultural Reputation: Viewed as sketchy, lawless, filled with bandits. Considered a "Demon's Pit" due to violent crime reputation.

MAGIC

—Relationship to Magic: [TBD] Magic Users (%): [TBD] Magic Institutions: [TBD]
Regulations: [TBD]

FOREIGN RELATIONS

—AICRUAE — Uneasy Neighbors Relationship: Thorny, characterized by distrust and occasional conflict
Aicruae's View: Seen as lawless, "sketchy" country filled with bandits
Border Issues: Porous and troubled; bandit raids and smuggling common
Trade: Minimal and unofficial despite Pireaynea's crop abundance; Aicruae's merchants deal through Ghercian intermediaries or black markets

Religious Divide: Pireaynea worships only Allan (monotheism), which Aicruae's clergy considers heresy against the Pantheon

Conflicts: Minor border wars sparked by Aicruan attempts to root out bandits or Pireaynean retaliation

Aicruae's Strategy: Fortify eastern towns (like Haleker); occasionally support Pireaynean warlords who promise stability

Summary: Guarded neutrality; no open conquest but no trust either

GHERCI - [TBD - founder fled from there after treason charges, implying complicated relationship]

COELUM — [TBD]

EQUATEIY - [TBD]

VIKITSV - [TBD]

HISTORY TIMELINE

- 7, 200 BR: Pireaynea founded by Deasn of Gherci (age 17) after fleeing treason charges [Date]: [Event] (Continue as needed)

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

- Significance in Book 1: Significance in Book 2: Significance in Book 3: Significance in Book 4: Key Scenes Set Here:

NOTES

- "The Demon's Pit" nickname refers to internal chaos and supposed criminal infestation, not literal geography
- Founder Deasn was considered a "good king" but his "weak nature" prevented long-term legitimization of the country
- The geography (flat, open, no natural barriers) ironically contributed to its lawlessness-trouble can move freely
- No official citizen registry has ever been produced
- Potentially rich agricultural land that never reached its potential due to governance failures

- Functions as Aicruae's problem neighbor-the source of border raids, smuggling, and instability
- The Pireaynea-Aicruae border is where Eastern Aicruae's town of Haleker is located, and citizens there must worry about conflicts

Primary Industries:

- Agriculture (grains: wheat, barley, corn; staple vegetables)
- Herding (cattle and sheep grazing on open range)
- Banditry and mercenary work (economy of plunder)

Economic Character: Pireaynea's economy was a paradox: rich in natural yield but poor in monetization. It survived largely on subsistence farming, and whatever wealth existed was concentrated in the hands of warlords or corrupt officials who extracted grain as tax and traded it illicitly.

Manufacturing: No significant manufacturing or crafts on an international scale; any traditional crafts (like leatherworking or rudimentary textiles) were cottage industries for local use. There were rumors of valuable resources (some say minor silver or copper deposits in the eastern hills), but exploitation never took off under the chaotic governance.

Trade: When it came to legitimate trade, Pireaynea was a blank spot-no established exports and thus often bypassed by merchants. The central authority was too weak to enforce tariffs or manage trade agreements. Much produce left via black markets or under-the-table deals with Gherci and Aicruae merchants.

RELIGION

- Primary Religion: Monotheistic worship of Allan (Goddess of the Earth/Nature) exclusively

Religious Character: Pireaynea's society was unusual in the region for being monotheistic. The people overwhelmingly worship Allan as the one and only deity, a departure from the polytheistic Circle of Eternal Light practiced in neighboring countries.

Historical Origin: Likely stems from the nation's founder, Deasn (a Ghercian exile), who perhaps encouraged devotion to Allan to differentiate his new realm from

Gherci's orthodox worship. Over generations, this evolved into outright monotheism—effectively, Pireaynea developed an Allan-centric cult that dismisses or downplays the other gods.

Worship Practices:

- Every village had a shrine to Allan, often a simple stone altar under an open sky
- Priests of Allan (both male and female) guided spiritual life
- Traditional Circle temples (Peknas) were not maintained
- Pireayneans performed rites directly in fields or groves, believing Allan was present in the land itself

Religious Standing: This religious difference gave Pireaynea a bit of a pariah status among neighbors—Gherci in particular labeled it heretical, and Aicruae viewed it as an odd aberration.

CULTURE & CHARACTER (Expanded)

—Language: Pocorki—presumably a dialect that might be mutually intelligible with Aicruan but distinct.

Fashion: Their style drew inspiration from colorful, somewhat flamboyant designs (perhaps a legacy of early settlers or trade), though the average peasant still wore simple tunics.

Social Life: Revolved around seasonal farming events and Allan-worship ceremonies. Festivals were tied to planting and harvest, with large communal feasts in Allan's honor and fertility rituals to bless the soil.

Class Structure:

- A small noble class (mostly self-styled lords controlling militias)
- A much larger peasantry
- A significant population of outlaws

Character: The lack of strong law made crime and violence part of daily life in some areas—hence the moniker “Demon's Pit” for its violent reputation. This

environment made Pireaynea's people hardy and self-reliant, but also left the society fragmented and lacking cohesion.

FOREIGN RELATIONS - AICRUAЕ (Expanded)

- Relationship: Thorny, characterized by distrust and occasional conflict; fraught and asymmetrical Pireaynea's Perspective: Aicruae was both a threat and a potential benefactor-stronger, more stable, and often condescending. Pireaynea's leaders tended to maintain a facade of friendliness to avoid giving Aicruae a casus belli, but resentment festered underneath.

Historical Grievances: Some Pireayneans believed Aicruae (and Gherci) never truly accepted Pireaynea's sovereignty since it was born from Gherci's rebel. Aicruae often treated Pireaynea like a turbulent hinterland rather than an equal state.

Diplomatic Contacts: Minimal-Aicruae kept an envoy in Civer to monitor the situation. Envoys from Civer occasionally came to Lajazer to request aid or mediation, typically meeting skepticism and strict terms.

Border Issues: The border was a hotspot. Aicruae built border forts and watchtowers to curb raiders and wasn't shy about pursuing bandits into Pireaynea if needed. Pireaynean authorities were too weak to protest strongly.

Trade Reality: Many common Pireayneans actually welcomed trade with Aicruans-a lot of surplus crop likely went west unofficially because farmers could barter with Aicruan merchants for tools or cloth that the dysfunctional Pireaynean system didn't provide.

Pre-Imperial Dynamics: Pireaynea became a pawn—both Aicruan loyalists and their enemies used Pireaynea as a staging ground or source of mercenaries. Rebel factions recruited Pireaynean fighters with promises of loot; loyalists bribed Pireaynean lords to deny passage to rebels.

Imperial Outcome: When Aicruae's empire absorbed everything, Pireaynea (renamed Lingia in the new imperial order) was placed under direct control and its anarchy subdued by imperial troops.

Summary: Pireaynea's stance was one of begrudging deference-superficial neighborliness masking bitterness. Aicruae's stance was guarded and interventionist-treat Pireaynea cordially in diplomacy but ready to interfere to

protect Aicruan interests.

[Coelum] "[The Land of Sand and Time]" / "[The Forsaken Land]"

BASIC INFORMATION

Common Names: The Land of Sand and Time, The Forsaken Land, The Forsaken

Place Flag: The flag presents a striking design of dark charcoal-black and olive-green sections fractured and divided by flowing white organic lines that curve and twist like rivers, flames, or the relentless passage of sand through an hourglass, with a small green triangle positioned at the top center. The white lines, which create an almost botanical or elemental pattern, flow from the center outward in asymmetrical waves, suggesting both the scattered, fragmented nature of Coelum's lost history—destroyed by countless wars and chaos—and the flowing sands that have earned it the nickname "land of sand and time." The dark colors dominate the composition, symbolizing the nation's grim reality as "the Forsaken Place": the black represents the mourning for a population devastated by famine and plagues, forcing many original inhabitants to flee, while the green might represent the meager hope found in their fishing economy and the kindhearted nature of the people who remain despite their hardships. The fractured, broken appearance of the design reflects both the country's founding by the drunken, irresponsible gambler Yuavekio the Wise (an ironic title), whose spending habits and gambling addiction plunged Coelum into an enormous debt they still struggle to repay, and their atheistic worldview—believing the gods have abandoned them, their faith as fractured as their flag. The white lines binding these dark fragments together might represent the resilience and kindness that holds the community together despite possessing the lowest valued currency in the world (Opeali at five dollars) and being forced to surrender 40% of their fishing earnings to Vikistv and Equateiy.

Basic Information: Coelum is a harsh, impoverished northern kingdom known for its wasteland geography and its population's near-total rejection of religion. After enduring plagues, famines, and abandonment by its ruling class, the people lost faith in the gods "who they say abandoned them to die."

Capital: Atriki

- Situated near a rare fertile spot, perhaps by a lake or one of the patchy rivers that still flow

- Likely in a valley that collects some water, making it habitable

Founded: By Yuavekio (date TBD) Founder: Yuavekio (a drunken explorer who accidentally found the land) Founding Information: Legend has it Coelum was accidentally found by a drunken explorer named Yuavekio who just stumbled into it, implying it wasn't an obviously fertile or strategic prize. Yuavekio's gambling and spending left an "enormous debt" that the nation never paid off.

GEOGRAPHY

- Location: North-central region of the continent, directly north of Gherci and west of Equateiy

Borders: South: Gherci East: Equateiy North: Henem Bay coastline

West/Northwest: Low mountains or broken terrain separating it from uncharted lands or ocean

Major Bodies of Water:

- Henem Bay (small northern coastline along an Arctic or northern sea)
- Scattered rivers and lakes (patchy, some possibly salt lakes)

Terrain Types:

- Northern highlands or plateaus
- Desertified flatlands (vast stretches of barren or sandy land)
- Possibly cold desert or steppe in the far north
- Southern part merges into semi-arid fringes of Gherci's steppes
- Tundra-like conditions near the bay in extreme north
- Ruin sites from prior eras scattered throughout

Climate: Harsh and unforgiving

- Colder than Aicruae or Gherci (far north, higher elevation)
- Winters: Long and bitter with frequent frosts or snows in uplands
- Summers: Short, scorchingly hot in day (plateaus/deserts) but cold at night
- Rainfall: Scarce and erratic; some years droughts, others sudden flash floods

- Typical highland continental climate with great temperature swings

Landscape Character: Dusty plains, rocky outcrops, and ghost towns. Wars and plagues emptied many villages, leaving crumbling structures gradually swallowed by sand. Pockets of green exist—oases or valleys with springs where stubborn communities cling on. The color palette is gray and tan. Fierce winds howl across flat expanses, and time seems to stand still in empty horizons. One traveler described it as “trash/useless land.”

POPULATION

- Total Population: Dwindled massively; many original inhabitants fled to other countries during the worst years

Ethnic Composition: [TBD]

Population Character: Those who remained or repopulated were hardy and kind-hearted folks—ironically, despite losing faith, Coelum’s survivors became known for their compassion and resilience. Enduring hardship fostered a strong community ethic.

GOVERNMENT

Government Type: Weak/Failed State (initially monarchy under Yuavekio, later council or Equateiyan administrators)

Power Structure: Society was not highly stratified—any nobility had long lost relevance after Yuavekio’s line failed. Local elders or warlord-like figures held authority in pockets, but many communities were small self-governing groups.

ECONOMY

- Currency: Opeali
- Lowest valued currency known (about \$5 each)
- Practically useless outside Coelum
- Many merchants refused Opeali, preferring barter or Equateiy’s Pel

Primary Industries:

- Fishing in Henem Bay
- Small-scale farming or herding in marginal lands
- Artisanal salt mining
- Scavenging ruins for scrap

Economic Status: Impoverished and reliant on foreign aid. Historically bankrupted by founding ruler Yuavekio's gambling and spending, leaving an enormous debt never paid off.

Debt Arrangements: To service these debts, Coelum gave away up to 40% of any national earnings to Equateiy and Vikitsv in exchange for continued financial support. Most meager revenues immediately flowed out to creditor states.

Mineral Rumors: There were rumors of mineral wealth (low-grade iron, tin, or precious stones in highlands), but if so, they were exploited under foreign supervision or not at all due to lack of capital.

Trade Status: Coelum sat on no major crossroads; most traders detoured around it because it offered little to buy and its roads were poor. Some Equateiyan and Vikitsv traders established outposts just to ensure debt repayments.

Daily Commerce: Barter was common—fish traded for grain (from Equateiy shipments) or firewood (maybe imported, since Coelum lacks forests).

Summary: Coelum's economy was collapsed—arguably the weakest on the continent—and largely a ward of its richer neighbors.

RELIGION

- Primary Religion: Mostly atheistic

Religious Character: Uniquely, Coelum became a mostly atheistic society in a world of devout neighbors. After enduring plagues, famines, and abandonment by its ruling class, the people lost faith in the gods "who they say abandoned them to die."

Historical Background: Whereas once Coelum might have followed the Pantheon (perhaps under Yuavekio they nominally worshiped like Gherci), over time shrines fell into disuse and the populace grew bitterly secular. Many came to view religion as a cruel joke, focusing instead on day-to-day survival.

Nature of Atheism: Born of despair rather than philosophy—a collective trauma response to extreme suffering.

Religious Standing: Coelum earned epithets like “the Forsaken Land” due to this godlessness and its wasteland geography.

Practical Impact: The lack of religion meant fewer festivals or holidays; they likely observed only practical seasonal events without much ceremony. Ancestor remembrance may have replaced formal worship. Coelum’s people didn’t respect holy figures from other nations, sometimes causing friction when pilgrims passed through.

CULTURE & CHARACTER

- Fashion: The style of dress took inspiration from Scottish/Irish traditional clothing (plaid woolens, kilts, cloaks)—sturdy, warm garments needed for the climate, symbolizing humble endurance.

Education: Little formal education or literature left; much history was lost in the chaos.

Social Character: Coelum felt “stuck in time”—people living in semi-medieval simplicity, clocked by the sun and seasons with no grand progress. Hardened but surprisingly gentle with one another, forged by shared suffering.

Atmosphere: A land that feels timeless and forlorn, contributing to spiritual desolation.

FOREIGN RELATIONS - AICRUAЕ

—Relationship: Neutral pity; minimal direct interaction (separated by Gherci)

Aicruae’s View: Sympathy and distance. Coelum wasn’t a threat (no military might) nor particularly useful as a trade partner—primarily a humanitarian concern.

Refugees: When waves of refugees fled Coelum during famines, some trickled toward Aicruae. Aicruae’s policy was likely charitable, taking in displaced people (especially since Aicruae’s west had labor shortages).

Diplomatic Standing: Aicruae recognized whatever government claimed Coelum but formal diplomacy was minimal. Aicruae did not station an ambassador in Atriki; communications were often via Gherci or Equateiy.

Aid: Aicruae occasionally sent aid or participated in international relief efforts (physicians, herbal remedies) partly out of altruism, partly to prevent plague spread.

Political Constraints: Coelum was so indebted to Equateiy/Vikitsv that Aicruae had to avoid stepping on those powers' toes. Aicruae deferred to Equateiy's lead on Coelum.

Exiles: Aicruae quietly harbored Coelumi exiles at times, employing them or giving sanctuary both out of pity and to gain information. These exiles influenced Aicruae public opinion to view Equateiy's exploitation critically.

Pre-Imperial Alignment: Coelum leaned toward Equateiy/Vikitsv (because they owned its debt) and would likely align against any Gherci-Aicruae bloc if pushed. But Coelum's contribution was minimal (mostly allowing harbors/territory to be used by Equateiy).

Imperial Outcome: When Aicruae's empire formed, Coelum (renamed Hikai in the new order) was easily absorbed as a vassal since it had no strength to resist.

Summary: Aicruae viewed Coelum with a mix of pity and pragmatic indifference-helping where convenient but otherwise staying out of its bleak fate.

NOTES

The epithet "Land of Sand and Time" suggests vast barren stretches and a timeless, forlorn quality

- "The Forsaken Land/Place" refers to both godlessness and geography
- Yuavekio's misrule created generational debt that defined Coelum's relationship with Equateiy/Vikitsv
- Despite losing faith, survivors became known for compassion-a paradox worth noting
[Equateiy]
"[The Kingdom of Gold]" / "[The Land of Secrets]"

BASIC INFORMATION

Official Name: Equateiy

Common Names: The Kingdom of Gold, The Place of Sin, The Land of Secrets

Flag: Pale tan upper field transitioning to rich golden-yellow horizontal band along bottom. Centered eight-pointed compass star rendered entirely in gold, with four elongated primary points extending toward cardinal directions like gilded daggers, and four shorter intermediate points creating a complete starburst effect. The star's geometric precision and sharp, blade-like qualities suggest both the navigational prowess required for international banking and trade, and the dangerous, secretive nature of a land known as "the place of sin, the land of secrets." The gold coloring symbolizes the immense wealth accumulated through Equateiy's jewel mines and banking empire, as well as the supremacy of their currency, the Pel, valued at fifty dollars each-the highest in the world. The star itself can be interpreted as a symbol of guidance and prominence, reflecting Equateiy's position as the most influential and well-known country, while its sharp points might represent the hidden power of House Kivier, the secretive unofficial rulers whose true history remains shrouded in mystery, their influence radiating outward like the star's rays to touch every corner of the known world.

Founded: 8,900BR

Founder: Yemaser of House Kivier

Founding Information:

Equateiy is among the oldest of existing countries, having some claim to formation before the Warriors Age. However depending on who you ask such a claim holds no grounds and is completely incorrect. House Kivier are the country's founders and first official nobles of Equateiy, but why they hadn't chosen to become monarchs instead no one knows. This and the real story behind Equateiy's creation no one truly knows - partially because Equateiy is so old and partially because House Kivier is so secretive.

Total Population: 97 Million People

Gender Breakdown: 55% Male, 45% Female

Ethnic Composition:

[Taili]: [%]

[Barie]: [%]

[Nemerl]: [%]

[Guio]: [%]

(Note: Home to those of Taili, Barie, Nemerl and Guio origin. Percentages TBD.)

Capital: Ociyaran

Places;

The Nedi Forest :

- The Nedi Forest is a forest located in Equateiy where Vandrea and Apharia Asleleri settled after approximately a year and a half on the run from Solis's forces (~ 7, 213 – 7, 212*BR*). The two sisters built a home here and lived a simple life - a stark contrast to their former privileges as daughters of a city lord. Vandrea, who understood little about manual labor, supported them by selling flowers, herbs, and wood from their section of the forest in the nearby town of Aslwal, leaving Apharia alone for days at a time.
- It was in the Nedi Forest that Apharia first encountered the mysterious man she would come to know as Soli (Paxtino/Ekhasostio in mortal form). While retrieving berries, she was chased by a bear and stumbled into him; he struck the bear down with a wave of energy. Apharia returned to the same spot in the forest day after day, waiting from noon to dark for Soli to reappear. Their relationship - and eventually Apharia's pregnancy - began here, triggering the chain of events that led to the Second War of the Gods.
- After Apharia left with Soli, Vandrea continued living in the Nedi Forest alone, using it as her base while she searched for Enyokia. It was to this house that Soli eventually returned, carrying the bodies of Apharia and her daughter.
- Located Near: Aslwal (town)

Significance: Vandrea and Apharia's refuge in exile; where Apharia met Soli; where Vandrea received Apharia's and her niece's bodies

Featured In: A Tale of Three Sisters

Aslwal :

- Aslwal is a town in Equateiy located near the Nedi Forest. While living in exile in the Nedi Forest, Vandrea Asleleri traveled to Aslwal regularly to sell flowers, herbs, and wood to support herself and her sister Apharia. These trips took Vandrea away from home for days at a time, leaving Apharia alone - which is how Apharia came to meet Soli in the forest.

- Aslwal appears to be a modest settlement, the kind of market town where a woman selling forest goods would not attract undue attention — important for two fugitives trying to remain hidden from Solis's forces.
- Located Near: Nedi Forest

Significance: Vandrea's market town during her exile; her absences here enabled Apharia's meetings with Soli

Featured In: A Tale of Three Sisters

Esteria - A City

Fashion:

- Equateiy believes in displaying wealth through fashion
- Known for elaborate and bold fashion
- When it comes to culture and fashion, Equateiy and Gherci are often seen butting heads because of how greatly their ideals conflict with one another

NEGIET:

- Negiet is the place of origin of Isenaylini Leum/Asleleri, the mother of Enyokia and Vandrea Asleleri.
- Significance: Birthplace/origin of Isenaylini Leum

Featured In: A Tale of Three Sisters (referenced in backstory).

GEOGRAPHY

-

Location: Northeastern highlands of the continent

Borders:

South: Vikitsv

West: Coelum

North/East: [TBD - possibly ocean or uncharted]

Major Bodies of Water:

- The Oberyia Sea (northeastern coastline)

Terrain Types:

- High-altitude plateaus and elevated terrain
- Mountain range along western edge forming natural border with Coelum and Vikitsv
- Rugged, elevated landscape throughout

Climate:

- Cool alpine conditions in mountainous areas
- Mild and temperate along eastern Obery Sea coastline
- Likely colder overall due to elevation

POPULATION

Total Population: [TBD]

Ethnic Composition:

[Taili]: [%]

[Barie]: [%]

[Nemeru]: [%]

[Guio]: [%]

(Note: Described as cosmopolitan and diverse)

GOVERNMENT

Government Type: Unofficial oligarchy ruled by House Kivier

Power Structure:

- No formal king or organized government body
- House Kivier acts as the unofficial/official rulers
- House Kivier views themselves as royalty though not actually royalty
- House Kivier's true history remains shrouded in mystery

ECONOMY

Currency: Pel

- Valued at roughly \$50 USD each
- THE HIGHEST VALUED CURRENCY IN THE WORLD
- Reflects global trust in Equateiy's banking system

Primary Industries:

- Sophisticated banking and financial services
 - Jewel and precious metal mining
- Maritime trading
- Luxury goods production and export
 - Manufacturing of quality goods

Major Exports:

- Gems and precious metals
- Manufactured luxury goods
- Financial services (loans, banking)
- Quality crafted tools

Major Imports:

- Foodstuffs from agricultural nations like Aicruae

Wealth Distribution: Meritocratic society where wealth determines status more than birth

Economic Character: Equateiy's economy is based on banking houses, jewel mines, and sophisticated trade networks. Their financial leverage extends across the continent through loans and economic entanglement.

CULTURE

Defining Values: Wealth, commerce, cosmopolitanism, worldliness, meritocracy

Social Character:

- Worldly and cosmopolitan
- Less rigid social hierarchy than Gherci
- Wealth-focused culture where merit matters more than birth

- Diverse population mixing multiple ethnic groups
- More progressive/Enlightenment-style values

Fashion: [TBD]

Cultural Reputation:

- Known as “the most influential and well-known country”
- Viewed by traditionalist neighbors as decadent or sinful
- Called “the place of sin” by more conservative nations

RELIGION

Primary Religion: [TBD - but implied to be less devout than Gherci/Aicruae]

Religious Character: More secular/less theocratic in orientation; contrasts with Gherci’s zealous piety

FOREIGN RELATIONS

AICRUAЕ - Cautious Rivalry

Relationship: Correct but cool; tense beneath formalities; “cold war of coin and court”

Trade: Aicruae exports foodstuffs and raw materials; imports luxury goods, gems, crafted tools, and financial loans

Economic Leverage: Equateiy entangles Aicruae economically through loans on hefty terms

Ideological Conflict: Equateiy’s cosmopolitan, wealth-driven values clash with Aicruae’s traditional piety

Political Meddling: Equateiy funded dissident Aicruan nobles (notably Duke Reasaec Kivier backing

Prince Orcus’s rebellion)

Civil War Involvement: Backed the anti-monarch faction (Orcus) to break Aicruae from Gherci alliance

Post-Empire: Gambit failed after Solis’s victory; forced to accept diminished role

Summary: "Politely hostile - smiling in person, scheming behind the scenes"

GHERCI - Ideological Opposition

Relationship: Often butting heads due to conflicting ideals

Core Conflict: Gherci's modesty and piety vs. Equateiy's wealth display and secularism

Diplomatic Character: Equateiy viewed as representing "Enlightenment power" opposing Gherci's traditionalist bloc

VIKITSV - Allied by Shared Interests

Relationship: Strategic allies against Gherci-Aicruae bloc

Shared Values: Both favor secular/less theocratic policies; both opposed Solis's empire

Civil War: Allied together backing Orcus's rebel side

COELUM - Economic Dominion

Relationship: Creditor-debtor; Equateiy effectively controls Coelum through debt

Financial Control: Coelum gives 40% of national earnings to Equateiy (and Vikitsv) for continued support

NOTES

- House Kivier is the secretive power behind Equateiy's throne
- Equateiy's strategy toward rivals is economic leverage rather than military confrontation
- "Smiling in person, scheming behind the scenes" defines their diplomacy
- Treated Aicruae as "a junior state to be wooed or subverted, rather than confronted militarily"

Political Fractions;

First Movement Party

This fraction prioritizes the military and law enforcement and believes that the government should do everything in its power to defend its people and way of life. This includes House Rendenten, House Dasbe, House Ashonve, House Toallu,

House Veir, House Schmidtavaca, House Maro, House Reidskelisia as well as some other houses.

Second Movement Party

This faction believes that wealth is the key to a successful society and that the government should prioritize policies that promote economic growth. This includes House Kivier, House Imbrer, House Ganane, House Balewer, House Uaver, House Vesmen, House Adiye.

[Vikitsv]

"[The Floating Land]"

BASIC INFORMATION

Official Name: Vikitsv

Common Names: [TBD]

Flag: Divided into four quadrants with cream-colored upper left bearing a simple coral-orange sun, muted blue-grey upper right and lower left, vibrant coral-orange lower right, with central white diamond containing a majestic tree with brilliant orange autumnal foliage and grey trunk, roots prominently displayed beneath. The tree with visible roots symbolizes the deep foundations of magical knowledge cultivated by the Magic Tower and the great sorcerer Verna who founded Vikistv, while the autumn colors represent wisdom, transformation, and the alchemical processes central to their worship of Iswan, goddess of alchemy. The blue quadrants clearly reference the defining characteristic of Vikistv's people-their blue hair and blue eyes-as well as the many layers of blue clothing they wear to withstand the coldest climate in the world atop Mount Aicren. The rope border suggests both the treacherous three-month journey up the mountain (where many have perished) and the interconnected nature of magical study, while the stars represent the enlightenment and mastery achieved by the best and brightest magic users who comprise the Magic Tower, making Vikistv the second most influential "country" globally through their exclusive exportation of magical items and tools that no other nation can replicate.

Capital: Berlailia

- Likely located on one of the rare lower plateaus or coastal foothills
- Possibly by the sea for easier access to supplies, or at a mountain pass

Founded: [TBD]

Founder: House Orana (descended from Verna's eldest son Liaerto I)

GEOGRAPHY

Location: Eastern peninsula of the continent, covering eastern and southeastern extremities

Borders:

North: Equateiy

West: Gherci

East: The Obery Sea (maritime)

South: The Fetora Sea (maritime)

Major Bodies of Water:

- The Obery Sea (eastern coastline)
- The Fetora Sea (southern coastline)

Defining Geographic Feature: Sits "upon a giant mountain called Aicren"

- Essentially a mountain kingdom, comparable to Tibet
- Single massive mountain or range dominates the country's interior
- Interior consists of high-altitude terrain
- Steep cliffs dropping to narrow coastal plains on the east
- Broader but still small southern coast

Terrain Types:

- Towering peaks, deep valleys, rugged plateaus
- Cascading waterfalls from glaciers
- Crystal-clear alpine lakes
- Mist-filled pine forests on mountain slopes
- Two forests (likely coniferous) in lower elevations or sheltered valleys
- Fjord-like inlets and treacherous cliffs along Obery Sea coast

- Southern coast less steep with natural harbors

Climate: COLDEST IN THE ENTIRE KNOWN WORLD

- Due to height of Mount Aicren
- Temperatures low year-round in most of country
- Peaks snow-capped even in summer
- Biting winds
- Winters: Long and severe with heavy snowfall on heights, freezing rain/sleet near sea level
- Summers: Brief and cool; only southernmost coast sees moderately warm days

Arable Land: EXTREMELY SCARCE ("Little Fertile Land")

- Only a few valleys or coastal patches can support crops
- Population clusters in limited arable zones

Travel Difficulty: Takes THREE MONTHS on average to reach Vikitsv; many have died venturing up the long mountain stretch

POPULATION

–

Total Population: ~ 46 Million

Gender Breakdown: 49% Female, 51% Male

Ethnic Composition:

[Guio]: Predominant (people with East Asian features)

Distinctive Features: People of Vikitsv are known for their blue hair and blue eyes

Population Distribution: Most cluster in limited arable zones-valleys where rivers meet the sea with alluvial soil

Government Type: Magocracy / Meritocracy

Power Structure:

- Governed by Council of Scholars

- Ruled by House Orana
- House Orana is unique: direct pure breed line of Verna descent
- Specifically descended from Verna's eldest son Liaerto I
- Verna personally had Liaerto I drink his blood
- Makes House Orana the most powerful line of magic users currently in existence
- The Magic Tower holds all the country's power

ECONOMY

Currency: Kis (gems used as currency)

- Valued at roughly \$30 USD each

Primary Industries:

- Exportation of magical items and tools created by the Magic Tower
-Precision instruments
- Rare mineral extraction
- Education services (training wizards)
- Superior steel weapons and fine craftsmanship

Economic Character: Economy centered almost entirely on Magic Tower exports- highly coveted because only Vikitsv can produce them

Major Exports:

-Magical items and tools (exclusive)

- Precision instruments (astrolabes, clockwork mechanisms)
- Superior steel weapons
- Fine craftsmanship
- Advanced crafts

Major Imports:

- FOOD (relies heavily on imports due to scarce arable land)
- Supplies and provisions from trade partners

Trade Partners: House Arvento of Aicruae accumulated great wealth through Vikitsv trade generations before Solis

MILITARY

Strategic Position: Mountain location makes invasion impractical; natural walls of rugged mountains separate it from neighbors

Accessibility: Only via the sea can Vikitsv be easily reached

- Southern ports on Fetora Sea (connecting to Aicruae's waters)
- Eastern ports on Obery Sea (connecting to global routes)

RELIGION

Primary Religion: Monotheistic worship of Iswan (goddess of alchemy) primarily

Religious Character:

- Worships Iswan as supreme god
- Also respects Nellebrie (who created Mount Aicren)
- Very monotheistic compared to other nations

Worship Practices:

- Magic users pray at the statue of Iswan almost twenty times a day to thank her for their gifts
 - 60-foot tall statue of Iswan stands in the center of the Magic Tower

CULTURE

-

Defining Values: Knowledge, magical scholarship, autonomy, austerity

Social Character:

- Knowledge-focused society
- Relatively modern compared to other countries

- Austere conditions for commoners due to harsh climate
- Secular, scholarly orientation

Fashion:

- Style/fashion inspiration from traditional Spanish clothing
- People wear many more layers than other nations
- Only wear BLUE articles of clothing

Cultural Reputation: Known as “the heartland of organized magic”

MAGIC

-

Magic Institutions: THE MAGIC TOWER

- Created by descendants of Verna in 7,749 BR
- Located on the right side of Mount Aicren at lower standing than capital
- Positioned so anyone entering the city must pass the tower first
- Under constant protection
- Holds roughly 400 wizards at a time for teaching and training
- Originally controlled by Ulian and his sons Kiear and Liaerto III
- Passed down generation to generation from fathers to sons
- Current Grand Sorcerer is child of Ulian's son Kiear

Magic Character: Vikitsv wouldn't accept any regime that would “hem in mages”- magical autonomy is paramount

FOREIGN RELATIONS

AICRUAE - Cautiously Neutral to Hostile

Pre-Empire Relationship: Formally neutral, occasionally friendly through trade

Trade: Aicruae provided food and supplies; Vikitsv provided high-quality tools and knowledge

House Arvento Connection: Started trade with Vikitsv generations before Solis, accumulating great wealth

Political Distance: Vikitsv's secular, scholarly orientation contrasts with Aicruae's piety

Minimal Interaction: No shared border (Gherci lies between); few Aicruans visited except scholars

Implicit Live-and-Let-Live: Vikitsv's mountain location made invasion impractical; Vikitsv had no interest in conquering west

Civil War: Backed Orcus's rebel side to prevent Solisian empire from threatening magical autonomy

Post-Empire: Vikitsv's open opposition led to forcible integration; imperial armies eventually purged

Vikitsv's nationalist core

Summary: "Cautiously neutral (trading) shifting to hostile when Aicruae became poised to dominate via empire"

GHERCI - Ideological Opposition

Relationship: Vikitsv in opposite camp from Gherci

Core Tension: Vikitsv's focus on magic vs. Gherci's religious orthodoxy

International Stance: At international gatherings, Vikitsv sided with Equateiy's proposals (favoring scientific/less theocratic policies)

EQUATEIY - Strategic Allies

Relationship: Allied in the Equateiy camp against Gherci-Aicruae bloc

Shared Values: Both secular, both opposed traditional religious bloc

Civil War: Allied together backing Orcus

COELUM - Economic Influence

Relationship: Creditor (with Equateiy); Coelum gives 40% of earnings to both nations

KEY LOCATIONS

The Magic Tower:

- Created: 7,749 BR

- Location: Right side of Mount Aicren, below capital city
- Purpose: Teaching and training wizards
- Capacity: ~ 400 wizards at a time
- Notable Feature: 60-foot statue of Iswan in center

During the Aicruan Civil War, the Magic Tower - under the leadership of Grand Sorcerer Sevtor (a direct descendant of Verna's eldest son Liaerto I) — allied with Orcus. Sevtor personally traveled to Aicruae with his family to provide magical military support. After Sevtor's devastating attack on Valea killed 15,000, Solis retaliated by burning the entire House Orana alive using Liacaion. Only Mekean Orana escaped, continuing the bloodline that eventually produces

Merigen Bleelack. The destruction of House Orana effectively decapitated the Magic Tower's leadership and triggered Solis's broader persecution of magic users across the empire.

Torad:

- Torad is a small village located in what was formerly known as Vikistv, detached from the main city. It served as Vikistv's primary agricultural farm, making it essential to feeding the mountain-bound population despite Vikistv's notoriously scarce arable land. The town was governed by City Lord Ceval Asleleri, who oversaw its farming operations alongside his eldest daughter Enyokia. Ceval was a close friend of Grand Sorcerer Sevtor, which connected Torad to the Magic Tower's political network despite its rural character.
- Because of Ceval's ties to Sevtor and the Magic Tower, Torad was among the first places targeted when King Solis of Aicruae began trying to conquer Vikistv (~ 7, 214 BR). Solis rounded up all high officials, sentenced Ceval to death, and dismantled the town's leadership. Torad's agricultural role made it strategically valuable to the Solisian Empire's expansion - its farmland would feed occupying forces.
- Notable Residents: City Lord Ceval Asleleri; Enyokia, Vandrea, and Apharia Asleleri (Ceval's daughters); Natav Yailk (Enyokia's fiancé, incoming Grand Sorcerer); Royin Yailk (Natav's cousin)

- Noble House Presence: House Yailk (through Natav and Royin)
- Featured In: A Tale of Three Sisters

Vekit:

- A Town

Negiet:

- A town (House Leum, is from here)

The Silora forest :

- The Silora Forest is a forest located within Vikistv. During Solis's conquest of Vikistv (~ 7, 214 BR), Vandrea and Apharia Asleleri were deep within the Silora Forest at the time of the attack, which is why they managed to escape while their father was executed and their sister Enyokia was sold into slavery. Vandrea used her magic to shield them from Solis's soldiers as they fled through the forest and crossed the sea by boat.
- The Silora Forest holds symbolic weight in Vandrea's story. At the end of A Tale of Three Sisters, after burying both her sisters and returning to Vikistv, Vandrea walks through the streets seeing statues of Solis and people worshipping the Circle of Eternal Light. She eventually makes her way back to the Silora Forest, where she grasps a dirty dahlia on the ground and hears a whispering voice (Renedin) asking her if she wants revenge. The forest where she escaped is the same forest where her path toward vengeance begins.
- Significance: Escape route for Vandrea and Apharia; site of Vandrea's first encounter with

Renedin's voice

- Featured In: A Tale of Three Sisters

NOTES

- Vikitsv is essentially a "magic tower" nation-the academy IS the state
- House Orana's pure Verna bloodline makes them uniquely powerful
- The three-month journey and dangerous mountain terrain kept Vikitsv historically isolated

- Blue-haired, blue-eyed people wearing only blue clothing creates a distinctive visual identity
- "Heartland of organized magic" that wouldn't accept any empire that would restrict mages

Political Fractions ;

The Nationalist Party

They believe that their nation is superior to others and therefore must protect their interests at all costs. This includes House Orana, House Renililas, House Yalik, House Qari and some other noble houses.

Traditionalist Party

This faction believes in the power and importance of tradition and the sacrifices made by those who have come before them. This includes House Navefa, House Miaran, House Iriandet, House Anasetanya, House Leum and some other noble houses.

The Mystic Isles

The Mystic Isles are a neutral territory belonging to the gods. While it legally belongs to Aicruae, no king has staked actual claim to it since the country's founding. Many believe that the isles are a link between the world of the gods and the world of the mortals. Many who venture there never return, and many have claimed to hear the voices of the gods while visiting.

The isle is comprised of only two gates. Legend says one leads to salvation and the other leads to ruin. Supposedly the gates were created after the birth of the twin gods Ekhasostio and Paxtino. Both gods stand at their respective gates waiting to test any individual wanting to pass through them.

THE MYSTIC ISLES

Region: Neutral territory (legally belongs to Aicruae but no king has staked actual claim

since the country's founding) Type: Sacred / Neutral Ground

Description: The Mystic Isles are believed to be a link between the world of the gods and the world of mortals.

Many who venture there never return, and many have claimed to hear the voices of the gods while visiting. The isles comprise two gates - legend says one leads to salvation and the other to ruin. The gates were created after the birth of the twin gods Ekhasostio and Paxtino, who stand at their respective gates waiting to test those who wish to pass.

War Significance:

- Solis fled to the Mystic Isles after the coup (~ 7, 241BR) and made his pledge to Razar there
- Solis trained and built his mercenary army on the isles under the alias "Jonathan Kiva"
- The Mystic Isles served as the neutral meeting ground where Mihel first encountered "Janrano Kiva" and eventually uncovered Solis's true identity
- After the war, Mihel Kulio retreats to the Mystic Isles, swearing off women and promising his family line will end with him

Chapter References: Ch. 5-6

Cross-references:

- SOLIS ELIAS PATTON (In Story Characters)
- MIHEL KULIO (In Story Characters)
- RAZAR (Religion)
- EKHASOSTIO & PAXTINO (Religion - Divine Family Tree)

THE ACADEMY ISLAND

[Type: Magical Institution / Neutral Territory]

BASIC INFORMATION

Name: The Academy Island

Also Known As: The Solisian Academy, The Academy

Type: Magical institution and surrounding settlement on an island

Nation: Neutral (located between Civer and Atriki borders on the main continent, in the Fetora Sea)

Region: Southern edge of the continent, offshore

Population: [TBD]

MISSION STATEMENT

"Greetings esteemed guests, and welcome to The Solisian Academy, where the pursuit of excellence is not merely a goal, it is a way of life. We take immense pride in our unwavering commitment to maintaining our impeccable standards, which have remained steadfast for over a decade. Our admission process is highly selective and reserved only for those who possess exceptional qualities, ensuring that our prestigious institution remains exclusive and reserved for the elite. Here at The Solisian Academy, we are dedicated to cultivating the next generation of leaders who will shape the future. Our mission is to instill in our students the values of compassion, integrity, and accountability, which are essential for success in any field. Our courses are designed to challenge and inspire our young scholars, surpassing even the most exclusive private schools. Our ultimate aim is to create perfect lords and ladies who will grace the highest echelons of society with their intelligence, poise, and grace. We aspire to not only ensure our students achieve success but to embody the spirit of our beloved Solis, who now rests in the land of the eternal sun. We firmly believe that by nurturing our students' minds and hearts, we can create a brighter future for all. We cordially invite you to join us and become part of the esteemed Solisian family."

GEOGRAPHY & LAYOUT

the Fetora Sea, directly south of the Civer-Atriki border on the main continent.

Climate: [TBD]

Layout/Structure: The entire island is deliberately compartmentalized into three zones connected by a narrow isthmus:

Upper Peninsula (Academy Plateau):

Surrounded by the Main Barrier—a solid, curved wall enclosing the core institution.

Contains: Academy Building (central), Library (NW edge), Training Grounds (north), Male Dorms (NE), Female Dorms (east).

Raised plateau transitioning to gentle slopes toward the sea.

Isthmus / Between the Barriers:

A narrow land bridge connecting the Academy plateau to the lower peninsula.

Marked by a corridor path running between the Main Barrier and the Second Barrier.

Lower Peninsula (Outer Town):

Enclosed by the Second Barrier (a lighter, outer wall).

Contains shops and administrative buildings.

Café Iri sits at the southern tip, a small outlying settlement just beyond the Second Barrier.

Notable Districts/Areas: Academy Plateau, Outer Town, Café Iri

Landmarks: The Main Barrier, The Second Barrier, The Library, Training Grounds, World Portals

(located on a separate landmass to the west of the island)

GOVERNANCE

-

Who Rules Here: The Principal (an artificial being - see Staff section)

Local Government: Academy administration overseen by the Principal and teaching staff

Relationship to Crown: Operates under the Solisian Empire but maintains institutional independence;

Emperor Goteivati Zivc I's ten rules do not apply here (Rule 11)

ACADEMY RULES

-

No Fighting.

All Students are Equal Regardless of Standing; Any Unfair and Biased Treatment will not be tolerated.

Students are required to take daily checkups and wellness monitoring.

Students are not allowed to be addressed by their position or standing while attending The Academy.

No talking during lunch; doing so will result in a point loss.

Male and Female students are not allowed to enter the dorms of each other.

Male and Female students must not display or participate in any acts of a public showing of love, regardless of their relationship.

No one is allowed out past 11. The barrier goes up at 11:00 and if you are late you are left.

Students must take six of the nine classes available at the school.

All mention of Emperor Solis outside of the classroom is strictly prohibited.

Emperor Goteivati Zivc I's ten rules do not apply here.

To enter the Solisian Academy you must pass all three steps of the application process.

ECONOMY & FUNCTION

Primary Purpose: Elite magical education and military training

Industries: Scholarly and magical instruction, Outer Town commerce

What It's Famous For: Being the premier magical academy of the Solisian Empire; training the next generation of lords, ladies, and leaders; home of the Special Division

Trade Significance: Outer Town provides shops and services for students and staff

STAFF

The Principal

The Principal isn't an actual person but a being. She doesn't age and she is capable of real emotions, but she was created by the Taten cousins and Professor Emisi to exist solely to protect the school. She was designed in the likeness of Siroa Taten's daughter, who passed away tragically in a fire. The Principal is a defense system - she is designed to sacrifice her life to protect the school if she must.

Normal Mode (Non-Attack): Long pink hair, light blue eyes.

Defense Mode: Hair shrinks into a short and fluffy black bob with faint strikes of black; eyes turn dark blue. (If she were alive, those white streaks would have been blue like her mother and aunt, but because she's not living, her hair is silver.)

Personal Detail: She likes pineapples - it's the only thing she can actually taste.
Professors:

**ProfessorAgeSubjectSiroa Taten32Ancient Ananara
LanguageRona Bicharaka47Elegance and
MannersEmisi Clyah51AlchemyKasria
Dulpy25Professor Dulpy's Magic CoursesVuard
Pegian43Foreign Relations and The Art of
UnderstandingFinsapre Aliolat35Physical
TrainingLyanami Taten27Business
ManagementBamavo Jaceri29Theory of
OriginLeranoan Gevhilem45Ethics and Lawful
Governing CLASSES & SCHEDULE**

Ancient Ananara Language

Professor: Siroa Taten

Schedule: Finore (Wednesday), Nellebrie (Thursday) - 9:00 am - 11:30 am

Description: This course focuses on studying and learning the Ananara language and applying what you have learned about the language to your magic.

Topics:

Year 2: Letters; Pronunciation of Letters; Sentence Structuring; Connecting Ananara to Magic Year 3: History of Name Merging; The Role of Ananara in

Spellcasting; Using Ananara to Strengthen and Extend Magic; Advanced Magic Techniques Using Ananara; Ananara and Symbolism Elegance and Manners

Professor: Rona Bicharaka

Schedule: Vapaz (Monday), Nimlye (Friday), Razar (Tuesday) - 12:00 pm - 3:40 pm

Description: As nobles the most important thing is how you conduct yourselves, the manners you display and how other members of society view you. This course is designed to teach you all the manners that will have you grace the social circles of the high court.

Topics:

Year 1: Dances (The Ansari, Cartose, Tal-Sel); Basic Manners (Court Manners, General Manners)

Year 2: Advanced Court Manners; The Art of Subtlety; Honorifics; Political Fractions; Royal Jewelry

Year 3: Desserts; Teas; Dinner Etiquette; Hosting Events; Decorating the Home

Year 4: Marriages and House Alliances; Basic History of Four Major Houses from History

Alchemy

Professor: Emisi Clyah

Schedule: Finore (Wednesday), Nellebrie (Thursday) - 2:00 pm -5:00 pm

Description: For those of you interested in joining either the Faku or Paosu Division, learning to use the elements around you is the single most important thing. These elements could be used to build and create things never seen before; by using basic components from our everyday lives we could create essentially anything.

Topics:

Year 2: History of Alchemy; Basic Components; Creating Basic Potions; Flowers and Plants Used in Alchemy (Isana, Hailets, Marcasye, Naila, Nari)

Year 3: Poisons Created with Alchemy (Joyless Death, Kan); Magical Items Created with Alchemy (Gifted Objects)

Professor Dulpny's Magic Courses

Professor: Kasria Dulpny

Schedule: Vapaz (Monday), Finore (Wednesday), Nellebrie (Thursday) - 6:30 am -

8:45 am Description: Magic is all around us and each of us possess it whether it be in a vast quality or a relatively small one. Each of us has the capability to use it. And so, it is important that we not only know how to wield it to our command but that we fully understand it.

Topics:

Year 1: General Introduction to the Magic System (Makito, Rusti, Javehet); Determining Your Magic Level; History of The Mystic Isles; History of the Magic Tower

Year 2: Deciphering Ancient Magic; Magic and Its Counters; Stabilizing and Focusing Magic

Year 3: Creating Magic Spells; Increasing Your Magic Output; Magic and Its Limitations - Knowing When You Have Hit Your Output Limit

Year 4: Creating Magical Sigils; Pairing Your Magic and Combining Magic Foreign Relations and The Art of Understanding

Professor: Vuard Pegian

Schedule: Vapaz (Monday), Razar (Tuesday) - 2:35 pm - 4:00 pm

Description: We are united under the king but nonetheless, through cultures and regional differences, it is important to understand how to communicate and connect with each other. In this course, we will explore the history of each of the six countries and how it affects how we interact with one another.

Topics:

Year 2: Important Historical Dates [Approved by the Royal Family] — The Warriors Age; The Massacre of Light; The Battle of Little Hill; Bloody Winter; The Battle of Grey Nest; The Siege of Highwater; The Great War; The Civer Civil War; The Great War of Tormet; Plagues (The Grandeí, Consieleté, Monstru)

Year 3: History of Lajazer; History of Civer; History of Tarmet; History of Atriki; History of Berlailia; History of Ociyaran

Physical Training

Professor: Finsapre Aliolat

Schedule: Nimlye (Friday) - 5:00 am - 6:30 pm

Description: "You most likely won't need to take this class because more than half of you will be surrounded by much more skilled guards at all times. And I really don't like teaching you all, but I guess, if you want to survive and learn some basic skills you should take this course."

Topics:

Year 1, Year 2, Year 3: Physical and Mental Training

Business Management

Professor: Lyanami Taten

Schedule: Vapaz (Monday), Nimlye (Friday), Razar (Tuesday) - 5:30 pm - 8:40 pm

Description: "Our world runs on money, and you need money to live, and unless you are the top 1% of aristocracy you will have to find out a way to gain enough wealth to sustain your family status."

Topics:

Year 1: How to Run a Household; How to Manage Land; Understanding Trade Routes; How to Gain Support for Your Business; Why It's Important to Have Stable Funds; Understanding Your Customers; How to Start a Business

Theory of Origin

Professor: Bamavo Jaceri

Schedule: Nellebrie (Thursday), Zopha (Saturday) - 5:30 pm - 8:00 pm

Description: "We all came from a song, or so the legends say. In this class we discuss religions, the gods, the saints, and the monsters some of us might have to fight."

Topics:

Year 2: The Gods of Old and New; The War of the Gods; The Sky People; The People of the Mountain; The Sun Forged; Demons/Monsters (Valoka's, Namilrane, Akotia Jerctika, Zelian, Lim, Vorel, Alem, Jali, Plova)

Year 3: The Cidet; The Saints; The Brotherhood of Westwinds; The Circle of Eternal Light; The Order of The Pure Ones

Year 4: The Mirrors of Nimlye; Allan of the Earth; The 12 Saints; The Wrath of Fire; The Myth of Ekhaostio and Paxtino; The Land Without Sun; Paha, Finore and the End; Noirta

Ethics and Lawful Governing

Professor: Leranoan Gevhilem

Schedule: Nimlye (Friday), Zopha (Saturday) - 12:30 pm - 3:00 pm

Description: "In this course, we talk and discuss. These discussions may involve topics you have learned about in other classes but generally it is a simple conversation."

Topics: [TBD - discussion-based format]

SPECIAL DIVISION

-

This division is highly specialized and has been established to train soldiers with the necessary skills to combat the constant threat posed by demons and monsters. If you have made the decision to join the Defense magical division, it means that you are an individual who has the potential to protect our glorious empire from any form of attack. As a member of this division, you will be responsible for executing covert missions and adhering to orders issued directly by the Council of Seven. Your commitment to the cause must be unwavering, and you must be willing to go above and beyond to achieve success.

Latest Team:

#NameRoleCode Name1Minara GoniãTeam LeaderBura2Nivaeran VeirFrontline

ManagerArgellon3Dahnyliein CaternSecondline ManagerMalign4Karniode
VesmenFrontline

DefenderNairan5Isaeri AshonveFrontline DefenderDorthargel6Vasert
PrairnSecondline

DefenderReron7Elleraian Betenadia PattonHealer / Secondline

DefenderAliirusk8Silaena

ChairameronWeapon Crafter / Gear MakingGalamma

Former Team:

#Code NameMagical AffinityRole1AArolimFrontline

Manager2K2KariLeader3K1KariSecondline

Manager

MAGICAL DIVISIONS

Magical and Non-Magical Divisions connected to and taught at the Academy:

Daseri [Fire Magic]
Faku [Alchemist Magic]
Haliver [Water Magic]
Utayer [Earth Magic]
Kari [Wind / Enhancement Magic]
Arolim [Holy / Healing Magic]
Minarei [Control / Puppetry Magic]
Yeohet [Light Magic]
Paosu [Non-Magical]
Gnati [Uncontrolled Magic]

CULTURE & CHARACTER

Atmosphere: Elite and regimented, with strict rules governing student behavior, but counterbalanced by the camaraderie among students and the eccentricities of individual professors. The Academy enforces equality among students regardless of birth or standing - a notable contrast to the class-stratified society of the broader Solisian Empire.

Local Customs: Titles and positions of standing are not used within Academy grounds. The barrier rising at 11:00 pm enforces a strict curfew. Silence during lunch is mandatory.

Religious Sites: [TBD]

FESTIVALS & EVENTS

—

Remembers Day — 01/26

Celebration of the Saints - 03/24

Unification of the Empire - 03/30

Festival of Worship - 05/01

Festival of the Sun - 06/14

Day of the Gods - 08/17

Martyrs' Festival - 08/29

Celebration of The Solis Empire - 09/23

Parents Day — 11/11

Festival of Mourning - 12/10

Festival of Unity - 12/21

Festival of the Moon - 12/30

DEMOGRAPHICS

—
-

Who Lives Here: Students (elite youths from across the Empire), faculty (nine professors), the Principal, support staff, Outer Town merchants and residents

Social Classes Present: Students of all noble ranks attend as equals (per Rule 2); commoners with exceptional qualities may also gain admission through the application process

Notable Residents: Professor Leranoan Gevhilem (secretly Soli); the Taten cousins (Siroa and Lyanami); Professor Emisi Clyah (co-creator of the Principal)

HISTORY

—

Founded: [TBD]

Major Historical Events: [TBD]

Changes Over Time: Appears across all three map eras (Crandona's and Minara's), suggesting it has endured through major political upheavals. Emperor Goteivati Zivc I's ten rules were explicitly excluded from Academy jurisdiction.

SENSORY DETAILS

•

What It Looks Like: [TBD]

What It Sounds Like: [TBD]

What It Smells Like: [TBD]

Unique Visual Details: No natural rivers on the island - water likely supplied via magic or cisterns.

Dotted paths suggest internal roads or magical pathways connecting each zone.

ROLE IN NARRATIVE

-

Scenes Set Here: The majority of Crown of Glory takes place at the Academy. Minara and Dahnyliein are sent here to study; Minara meets Nivaeran and the rest of the core cast; the Special Division operates covert missions from this base.

Why Characters Come Here: Magical education, military training, and the social formation of the Empire's future leaders.

Significance to Plot: The Academy is the primary setting where Minara's transformation from angry orphan to leader occurs. It's where her allies form, her abilities develop, and the conspiracy surrounding the demon attacks and Macenja's machinations begins to unravel. The Special Division's covert operations against demons/monsters are coordinated from here.

NOTES

The World Portals are located on a separate landmass to the west of the Academy Island, connected by what appears to be a dashed pathway (possibly a bridge, ferry route, or magical connection).

The island's compartmentalized design (inner sanctum → staff/student town → recreational café) suggests strict access control, with the barriers serving as both physical and possibly magical boundaries.

Across eras: Appears as "The Academy" in both the Crandona's Era map (south of Lingia) and the Minara's Era map (southwest of Civer). Its persistence through regime changes suggests institutional independence or neutrality that transcends political borders.

The Principal's existence as an artificial being created specifically for defense suggests the Academy has faced serious threats in its past — and that its founders (the Taten cousins and Emisi) anticipated future ones.

FAMOUS ALUMNI

- Atzasi Catern, Erela Taten, Nairan Aedria, Firi Mena, Kalio Taten, Taina Chairameron, Dita Der

Kulio, Toai Natin, Azukia Itaeri, Chrino Goag, Deber Der Bahsi, Milteri Bahsi, Lavon Tushol, Fipen Der Artian, Jako Artian

NOTABLE CURRENT STUDENTS

CROWN OF GLORY - ACADEMY & KEY SITES

THE TRAINING GROUNDS (GAVARA CASTLE)

Location: Gavara Castle, a quick twenty-minute walk from the Solisian Academy

Description: The castle belonged to a lesser lord whose family died during the Monstru Plague. After his death, the castle was abandoned. Because of its proximity to the Academy, it was “renovated” and converted into a training ground for students.

Significance: Primary training facility for Academy students and the Special Division. Its history as a plague-ravaged noble estate reinforces the theme of aristocratic decline in Crown of Glory.

Book Reference: A Crown of Glory (Book 4)

EMILLEA HALL (THE GIRLS’ DORMITORY)

Location: Solisian Academy campus

Description: The girls’ dormitory where Minara and the other female characters reside and spend their time at the Academy.

Significance: Minara’s home base at the Academy. Named after Lady Emillea Hige, a historical figure from

A Tale of a Thousand Songs - one of the Academy's famous alumni connections to the series' deeper history.

Book Reference: A Crown of Glory (Book 4)

CAFE IRI

Location: An out-of-commission portal that supposedly used to lead to the world of the gods

Description: The meetup spot for the main protagonists as they venture and explore their world and its mysteries.

Now in the present day, it is owned by a mysterious figure named Lady Zani. Lady Zani is actually the goddess Zopha in human form, unknown to everyone - she gave up most of her powers to assume human form and look after her son, the god Soli.

Significance: The fact that the cafe is located in a former portal signifies how the gods no longer have a connection to the mortals. It also serves as a hidden divine connection - Zopha watching over Soli from within a dead gateway to the realm she can no longer reach.

Book Reference: A Crown of Glory (Book 4)

THE GATE

Location: No fixed location - can spawn anywhere on the Mystic Isles at any given time

Description: A moving hell dimension that brings monsters from both the realm of the gods and the dream plane into the world of the mortals. It is essentially a roaming rift between realities.

Significance: The big mystery of the book revolves around The Gate - no one inside the world of the book knows why it appeared. At the end of the book, after the Empress is defeated, Minara and the other characters believe she caused it. The Gate is the physical manifestation of the corrupted world doors that Vandrea damaged during A Princess in Love, now worsened by Renedin's influence.

Book Reference: A Crown of Glory (Book 4) Cross-reference: KEY WORDS AND TERMS — The Gate

THE GREAT GARDEN

Location: A corner of the Solisian Academy, hidden away within a maze

Description: The place where the young prince Elleraian Betenadia Patton spends most of his time reading. A secluded, quiet corner accessible only through the Academy's maze.

Significance: The setting for Minara and Elleraian's early bonding scenes - where she begins to see him as a person rather than a symbol of the aristocracy she hates. Later becomes a symbol of the sibling relationship they don't yet know they share.

Book Reference: A Crown of Glory (Book 4)

THE BLOOD OF Ociyaran - Hymn made during The War of Ociyaran.